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Inventor(s)	Umezaki; Atsushi

Semiconductor device

Abstract

Provided is a semiconductor device which can operate stably even in the case where a transistor thereof is a depletion transistor. The semiconductor device includes a first transistor for supplying a first potential to a first wiring, a second transistor for supplying a second potential to the first wiring, a third transistor for supplying a third potential at which the first transistor is turned on to a gate of the first transistor and stopping supplying the third potential, a fourth transistor for supplying the second potential to the gate of the first transistor, and a first circuit for generating a second signal obtained by offsetting a first signal. The second signal is input to a gate of the fourth transistor. The potential of a low level of the second signal is lower than the second potential.

Inventors:	Umezaki; Atsushi (Kanagawa, JP)
Applicant:	Semiconductor Energy Laboratory Co., Ltd. (Atsugi, JP)
Family ID:	47141492
Assignee:	Semiconductor Energy Laboratory Co., Ltd. (Atsugi, JP)
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Primary Examiner: Nguyen; Long

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Fish & Richardson P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/711,120, filed Apr. 1, 2022, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,682,332, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/784,383, filed Feb. 7, 2020, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,295,649, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/109,857, filed Aug. 23, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,559,606, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 15/350,712, filed Nov. 14, 2016, now U.S. Pat. No. 10,062,717, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 14/790,309, filed Jul. 2, 2015, now U.S. Pat. No. 9,508,301, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 14/250,623, filed Apr. 11, 2014, now U.S. Pat. No. 9,106,224, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 13/468,135, filed May 10, 2012, now U.S. Pat. No. 8,698,551, which claims the benefit of a foreign priority application filed in Japan as Serial No. 2011-108133 on May 13, 2011, all of which are incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) One embodiment of the present invention relates to semiconductor devices and display devices.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) Display devices with higher value have been developed accompanying spread of large-sized display devices such as liquid crystal television. In particular, a technology of using transistors whose conductivity types are the same as each other in a driver circuit has been actively developed (see Patent Document 1).

(3) FIG. 23 illustrates a driver circuit described in Patent Document 1. The driver circuit described in Patent Document 1 includes transistors M1, M2, M3, and M4 and a capacitor C1. In Patent Document 1, in the case where a signal at high level is output as a signal OUT, a gate of the transistor M1 is made into a floating gate, and a bootstrap operation in which the potential of the gate of the transistor M1 is increased to be higher than a potential VDD by using capacitive

coupling of the capacitor C1. To make the gate of the transistor M1 into the floating gate, a transistor (e.g., the transistor M4) connected to the gate of the transistor M1 is turned on by making the potential difference between gate and source of the transistor (hereinafter, the difference is referred to as V_{gs}) 0 V.

(4) Further, in the case where a signal at low level is output as the signal OUT, a signal at high level is input as a signal IN, and thus the transistors M2 and M3 are turned on.

REFERENCE

(5) Patent Document 1: Japanese Published Patent Application No. 2002-328643

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) When a depletion transistor (also called a normally-on transistor) is used as the transistor, the transistor is not turned off at V_{gs} of 0 V. Therefore, in the case where the signal at high level is output as the signal OUT, the transistors M3 and M4 are not turned off, and thus the gate of the transistor M1 is not made into the floating gate. When the gate of the transistor M1 cannot be made into the floating state, the bootstrap operation cannot be performed normally, which may lead to malfunction or narrowing of the operating frequency range.

(7) Further, in the case where the signal at low level is output as the signal OUT, since the driving voltage of the driver circuit of a display device is high, V_{gs} of the transistor M2 and the transistor M3 are also large, which promotes degradation of the transistors and may cause malfunction of the driver circuit.

(8) In view of the above, one object of one embodiment of the present invention is to provide a semiconductor device which can operate stably even in the case where a transistor thereof is a depletion transistor. Further, one object of one embodiment of the present invention is to suppress degradation of a transistor.

(9) A semiconductor device of one embodiment of the present invention includes a first transistor for supplying a first potential to a first wiring, a second transistor for supplying a second potential to the first wiring, a third transistor for supplying a third potential at which the first transistor is turned on to a gate of the first transistor and stopping supplying the third potential, a fourth transistor for supplying the second potential to the gate of the first transistor, and a first circuit for generating a second signal obtained by offsetting a first signal. The second signal is input to a gate of the fourth transistor. The potential of a low level of the second signal is lower than the second potential.

(10) A semiconductor device of one embodiment of the present invention includes a first transistor for supplying a first potential to a first wiring, a second transistor for supplying a second potential to the first wiring, a third transistor for supplying a third potential at which the first transistor is turned on to a gate of the first transistor and stopping supplying the third potential, a fourth transistor for supplying the second potential to the gate of the first transistor, a capacitor whose one electrode is input with a first signal, and a fifth transistor for supplying a fourth potential to the other electrode of the capacitor. A gate of the fourth transistor is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor. The fourth potential is lower than the second potential.

(11) The first signal may be input to a gate of the second transistor in the above-described semiconductor device.

(12) According to one embodiment of the present invention, even in the case where a transistor is a depletion transistor, the transistor can be turned off. Further, the drain current of a transistor in the off-state can be decreased. Accordingly, malfunction of a circuit can be prevented. Further, according to one embodiment of the present invention, V_{gs} of a transistor can be decreased, whereby degradation of the transistor can be suppressed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIGS. 1A and 1B are diagrams for illustrating a semiconductor device according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (2) FIGS. 2A and 2B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (3) FIGS. 3A and 3B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (4) FIGS. 4A and 4B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (5) FIGS. 5A and 5B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (6) FIGS. 6A and 6B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a chart for illustrating a semiconductor device according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (8) FIGS. 8A and 8B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (9) FIGS. 9A and 9B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (10) FIGS. 10A to 10C are diagrams for illustrating a semiconductor device according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (11) FIG. 11 is a diagram for illustrating a shift register according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (12) FIG. 12 is a chart for illustrating a shift register according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (13) FIGS. 13A to 13C are views for illustrating display devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (14) FIGS. 14A to 14E are diagrams illustrating structures of oxide materials according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (15) FIGS. 15A to 15C are diagrams illustrating a structure of an oxide material according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (16) FIGS. 16A to 16C are diagrams illustrating a structure of an oxide material according to one embodiment of the present invention;
- (17) FIGS. 17A to 17D are diagrams illustrating structures of transistors according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (18) FIGS. 18A to 18C are graphs each showing characteristics of a transistor using an oxide semiconductor layer;
- (19) FIG. 19 is a graph showing a relation between off-state current and measuring substrate temperature of a transistor;
- (20) FIGS. 20A to 20D are views illustrating electronic devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (21) FIGS. 21A to 21D are views illustrating electronic devices according to embodiments of the present invention;
- (22) FIGS. 22A and 22B are diagrams for illustrating semiconductor devices according to embodiments of the present invention; and
- (23) FIG. 23 is a diagram illustrating a conventional driver circuit.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

- (24) Examples of embodiments of the present invention are described with reference to the drawings below. Note that it will be readily appreciated by those skilled in the art that details of the

embodiments can be modified in various ways without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention. The present invention is therefore not limited to the following description of the embodiments.

Embodiment 1

(25) In this embodiment, one example of a semiconductor device which is driven by a signal generated by offsetting an input signal is described.

(26) A configuration of a semiconductor device of this embodiment is described with reference to FIG. 1A. FIG. 1A is a circuit diagram of the semiconductor device of this embodiment. The semiconductor device in FIG. 1A includes a circuit **100** and a circuit **110**. The circuit **100** is connected to a wiring **11**, a wiring **12**, a wiring **14**, and the circuit **110**. The circuit **110** is connected to a wiring **15**, a wiring **13**, a wiring **16**, and the circuit **100**. The wirings and the like connected to any of the circuits **100** and **110** can be changed as appropriate depending on the configurations of the circuits **100** and **110**.

(27) Note that in this specification, the case where X and Y are electrically connected to each other, the case where X and Y are functionally connected to each other, and the case where X and Y are directly connected to each other are encompassed in the explicit description of “X is connected to Y”.

(28) Potential VL1 is supplied to the wiring **13**. The potential VL1 is a predetermined potential. The wiring **13** transmits the potential VL1.

(29) Potential VL2 is supplied to the wiring **14**. The potential VL2 is a predetermined potential and is lower than the potential VL1. The wiring **14** transmits the potential VL2.

(30) Potential VH is supplied to the wiring **15**. The potential VH is a predetermined potential and is higher than the potential VL1. The wiring **15** transmits the potential VH.

(31) The wirings **13**, **14**, and **15** are also called power supply lines. The potentials VL1, VL2, and VH are also called power supply potentials and each supplied from a power supply circuit or the like.

(32) Signal IN is input to the wiring **11**. The signal IN is an input signal of the semiconductor device. The signal IN is a digital signal whose high-level potential is VH and low-level potential is VL1. That is, either the potential VH or the potential VL1 is supplied to the wiring **11**. The wiring **11** transmits the signal IN.

(33) Signal SE is input to the wiring **12**. The signal SE is a signal for controlling the timing at which an offset voltage is generated. The signal SE is a digital signal whose high-level potential is higher than VL2 and low-level potential is lower than or equal to VL2. That is, either the potential higher than the potential VL2 or the potential lower than or equal to the potential VL2 is supplied to the wiring **12**. The wiring **12** transmits the signal SE.

(34) Signal OUT is output from the wiring **16**. The signal OUT is an output signal of the semiconductor device. The signal OUT is a digital signal whose high-level potential is VH and low-level potential is VL1. The wiring **16** transmits the signal OUT.

(35) The wirings **11**, **12**, and **16** are also called signal lines. Further, the signal IN, the signal SE, and the signal OUT are also called an input signal, a control signal, and an output signal, respectively.

(36) The circuit **100** generates a signal INO by offsetting the signal IN. That is, the circuit **100** generates the signal INO which is less than the potential of the signal IN by the offset voltage. The circuit **100** outputs the signal INO to the circuit **110**.

(37) The low-level potential of the signal INO is lower than the potential VL1 of the wiring **13**. On the other hand, the high-level potential of the signal INO is preferably higher than VL1 and lower than VH.

(38) The circuit **110** selects the high level or the low level of the signal OUT in response to the signal INO (output signal of the circuit **100**). For example, in the case where the circuit **110** is an inverter circuit, the circuit **110** outputs the low-level potential of the signal OUT when the signal

INO is at the high level, whereas outputs the high-level potential of the signal OUT when the signal INO is at the low level. The circuit **110** selects which of the potential of the wiring **15** and the potential of the wiring **13** is output to the wiring **16**, in response to the signal INO. For example, the circuit **110** outputs the potential of the wiring **13** to the wiring **16** when the signal INO is at the high level, whereas outputs the potential of the wiring **15** to the wiring **16** when the signal INO is at the low level. The circuit **110** also increases the high-level potential of the signal OUT to the potential VH of the wiring **15** by a bootstrap operation.

(39) Next, a specific example of the circuit **100** and the circuit **110** is described with reference to FIG. **1A**.

(40) The circuit **100** includes a capacitor **101** and a transistor **102**. One electrode of the capacitor **101** is connected to the wiring **11**. A first terminal (one of a source and a drain) of the transistor **102** is connected to the wiring **14**, a second terminal thereof is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**, and a gate thereof is connected to the wiring **12**.

(41) The circuit **110** includes transistors **111**, **112**, **113**, and **114**. A first terminal of the transistor **111** is connected to the wiring **15**, and a second terminal thereof is connected to the wiring **16**. A first terminal of the transistor **112** is connected to the wiring **13**, a second terminal thereof is connected to the wiring **16**, and a gate thereof is connected to a gate of the transistor **114**. A first terminal of the transistor **113** is connected to the wiring **15**, a second terminal thereof is connected to a gate of the transistor **111**, and a gate thereof is connected to the wiring **15**. A first terminal of the transistor **114** is connected to the wiring **13**, a second terminal thereof is connected to the gate of the transistor **111**, and the gate thereof is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**. A portion at which the gate of the transistor **111** is connected to another transistor (e.g. transistor **113**, transistor **114**) is denoted by a node N1.

(42) The capacitor **101** holds a potential difference between the wiring **11** and the second terminal of the transistor **102**. Thus, in the case where the second terminal of the transistor **102** is in the floating state, the potential of the second terminal of the transistor **102** varies in accordance with the signal input to the wiring **11**, i.e., the potential of the signal INO varies in accordance with the signal IN.

(43) The transistor **102** supplies the potential VL2 of the wiring **14** to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**. The timing at which the transistor **102** supplies the potential VL2 to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** is controlled by the signal SE of the wiring **12**.

(44) The potential supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** by the transistor **102** is lower than the potential VL1. Specifically, the transistor **102** supplies a potential lower than the potential of the first terminal of the transistor **114** to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**.

(45) The transistor **111** supplies the potential VH of the wiring **15** to the wiring **16**. The transistor **111** also holds a potential difference between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111**. Thus, in the case where the node N1 is in the floating state, the potential of the node N1 increases as the potential of the wiring **16** increases.

(46) In the case where a signal is input to the wiring **15**, the transistor **111** supplies the signal of the wiring **15** to the wiring **16**.

(47) The transistor **112** supplies the potential VL1 of the wiring **13** to the wiring **16**. The timing at which the transistor **112** supplies the potential VL1 to the wiring **16** is controlled by the signal INO (potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101**) output from the circuit **100**.

(48) The transistor **113** supplies the potential VH of the wiring **15** to the gate of the transistor **111**. After the potential VH is supplied to the gate of the transistor **111**, the transistor **113** stops supplying the potential VH to the gate of the transistor **111**. The transistor **113** keeps supplying the potential VH to the gate of the transistor **111** after the transistor **111** is turned on until the transistor **113** is turned off.

(49) The potential supplied to the gate of the transistor **111** by the transistor **113** is a potential at which the transistor **111** is turned on.

(50) The transistor **114** supplies the potential VL1 of the wiring **13** to the gate of the transistor **111**. The timing at which the transistor **114** supplies the potential VL1 to the gate of the transistor **111** is controlled by the signal INO output from the circuit **100**.

(51) The conductivity types of the transistors included in the semiconductor device of this embodiment (e.g., transistors **102**, **111**, **112**, **113**, and **114**) are the same as each other. Description is made in this embodiment in the case where the transistors included in the semiconductor device of this embodiment are n-channel transistors.

(52) Next, an example of a driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** is described with reference to FIG. **1B**. FIG. **1B** is an example of a timing chart for describing the driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A**.

(53) A period is divided into a period T0 and a period T1 for description of the driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A**.

(54) The period T0 is a period for holding an offset voltage in the capacitor **101**. First, the signal IN is set at a low level, so that the potential of the one electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes VL1. Further, the signal SE is set at a high level to turn on the transistor **102**. Consequently, the potential VL2 of the wiring **14** is supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**, so that the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes VL2. In this manner, a difference between the low-level potential VL1 of the signal IN and the potential VL2 of the wiring **14** supplied through the transistor **102**, i.e., the difference (VL1-VL2), is held in the capacitor **101**. The difference (VL1-VL2) corresponds to the offset voltage.

(55) In the period T0, a potential lower than VL1 is supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** through the transistor **102**.

(56) The period T1 is a period for generating the signal INO by offsetting the signal IN and driving the circuit **110** by the signal INO. First, the signal SE is changed to a low level to turn off the transistor **102**, whereby the other electrode of the capacitor **101** is made into a floating state. Since the capacitor **101** holds the potential difference (VL1-VL2) in the period T0, a signal obtained by subtracting the potential difference (VL1-VL2) from the potential of the signal IN is generated as the signal INO. Therefore, when the signal IN is at the low level, the signal INO becomes a low level whose potential is lower than VL1; when the signal IN is at the high level, the signal INO becomes a high level whose potential is lower than VH.

(57) The driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** in the period T1 is described with the case where the signal IN is at the high level and the case where the signal IN is at the low level.

(58) In the period T1, when the potential of the signal IN is changed to the high level, the signal INO becomes the high level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are turned on. Consequently, the potential VL1 of the wiring **13** is supplied to the wiring **16** through the transistor **112**. The potential VL1 of the wiring **13** is also supplied to the node N1 through the transistor **114**. The potential VH of the wiring **15** is also supplied to the node N1 through the transistor **113**. However, the potential of the node N1 becomes as low as a potential at which the transistor **111** is turned off, where the W (channel width)/L (channel length) ratio of the transistor **114** is sufficiently larger than that of the transistor **113**; thus, the transistor **111** is turned off. Accordingly, the signal OUT becomes a low-level potential which is VL1.

(59) On the other hand, in the period T1, when the level of the signal IN is changed to the low level, the signal INO becomes the low level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are turned off. Since the potential VH of the wiring **15** is supplied to the node N1 through the transistor **113**, the potential of the node N1 increases. Consequently, the transistor **111** is turned on, so that the potential VH of the wiring **15** is supplied to the wiring **16** through the transistor **111**, thereby increasing the potential of the wiring **16**. Then, the potential of the node N1 reaches a potential obtained by subtracting the threshold voltage of the transistor **113** from the potential VH, so that the transistor **113** is turned off to make the node N1 in a floating state. Even after the node N1 is

made in the floating state, the potential of the wiring **16** increases. In addition, a potential difference between the node **N1** and the wiring **16** at the time when the transistor **113** is turned off is held between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111**. Therefore, the potential of the node **N1** further increases to be higher than the potential **VH** along with the increase in the potential of the wiring **16**. The above is a so-called bootstrap operation. Accordingly, the signal **OUT** becomes a high-level potential which is **VH**.

(60) In the case where a signal is input to the wiring **15**, the signal is output to the wiring **16**. For example, in the case where a clock signal is input to the wiring **15**, the clock signal is output to the wiring **16** from the wiring **15** in the period during which the signal **IN** is at the low level.

(61) As described above, when the signal **OUT** is at the high level, the potential of the gate of the transistor **114** is lower than **VL1**, and thus V_{gs} of the transistor **114** is a negative value; therefore, even if the transistor **114** is a depletion transistor, the transistor **114** can be turned off, or even if the transistor **114** is a transistor whose drain current at V_{gs} of 0 V is large, the drain current of the transistor **114** can be suppressed. Accordingly, the gate of the transistor **111** can be made into the floating state, whereby malfunction of the circuit **110** can be prevented.

(62) Further, like the transistor **114**, V_{gs} of the transistor **112** is also a negative value. Therefore, even if the transistor **112** is a depletion transistor, the transistor **112** can be turned off, or even if the transistor **112** is a transistor whose drain current at V_{gs} of 0 V is large, the drain current of the transistor **112** can be suppressed. Accordingly, current flow from the wiring **16** to the wiring **13** can be prevented or suppressed, by which power consumption can be reduced.

(63) Further, when the signal **OUT** is at the low level, the potentials of the gates of the transistors **112** and **114** are lower than **VH**, and thus V_{gs} of the transistors **112** and **114** are small. Accordingly, degradation of the transistors **112** and **114** can be suppressed.

(64) Heretofore, the driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** is described.

(65) Next, semiconductor devices different from FIG. **1A** are described with reference to FIGS. **2A**, **2B**, **3A**, **3B**, **4A**, **4B**, **5A**, and **5B**. Description is made on portions different from FIG. **1A**, below.

(66) As shown in FIG. **2A**, the wiring **14** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **13**. Then, the potential **VL2** may be supplied to the wiring **13** in the period **T0** and the potential **VL1** may be supplied to the wiring **13** in the period **T1**. Even in that case, the potential **VL2** can be supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** in the period **T0**, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be attained. Further, since the wiring **14** can be omitted, the number of wirings can be reduced as compared to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A**.

(67) Further, in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **2A**, the potential of the wiring **13** may not be changed but remain the potential **VL1** and the potential of the wiring **11** may be set to be higher than the potential **VL1** and lower than the potential **VH** in the period **T0**. Even in that case, the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** can become a potential lower than the potential **VL1** when the signal **IN** is at the low level in the period **T1**, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be attained. Further, since the power supply potential can be fixed, a configuration of a power supply circuit to supply the potential to the wiring **13**, or the like can be simplified.

(68) As shown in FIG. **2B**, the wiring **14** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **15**. Then, the potential **VL2** may be supplied to the wiring **15** in the period **T0** and the potential **VH** may be supplied to the wiring **15** in the period **T1**. Even in that case, the potential **VL2** can be supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** in the period **T0**, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **1A** can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in

the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be attained. Further, since the wiring 14 can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A.

(69) As shown in FIG. 3A, the wiring 14 in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor 102 may be connected to the wiring 12 and the second terminal and the gate of the transistor 102 may be connected to the other electrode of the capacitor 101. Then, the signal SE may be set at the low level in the period T0 and at the high level in the period T1. Even in that case, the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor 101 can become a potential lower than the potential VL1 in the period T0, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be attained. Further, since the wiring 14 can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A.

(70) As shown in FIG. 3B, the wirings 12 and 14 in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor 102 may be connected to the wiring 13 and the second terminal and the gate of the transistor 102 may be connected to the other electrode of the capacitor 101. Then, the potential VL2 may be supplied to the wiring 13 in the period T0 and the potential VL1 may be supplied to the wiring 13 in period T1. Even in that case, the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor 101 can become a potential lower than the potential VL1 in the period T0, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be attained. Further, since the wirings 12 and 14 can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A.

(71) As shown in FIG. 4A, the wirings 12 and 14 in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor 102 may be connected to the wiring 15 and the second terminal and the gate of the transistor 102 may be connected to the other electrode of the capacitor 101. Then, the potential VL2 may be supplied to the wiring 15 in the period T0 and the potential VH may be supplied to the wiring 15 in period T1. Even in that case, the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor 101 can become a potential lower than the potential VL1 in the period T0, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be attained. Further, since the wirings 12 and 14 can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A.

(72) As shown in FIG. 4B, the gate of the transistor 112 may be connected to the wiring 11 in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4B, the timing at which the potential VL1 of the wiring 13 is supplied to the wiring 16 through the transistor 112 is controlled by the signal IN. Since the signal IN rises or falls faster than the signal INO, the transistor 112 can be turned on or off sooner than the case where the gate of the transistor 112 is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor 101. Accordingly, the timing at which the potential VL1 of the wiring 13 is supplied to the wiring 16 becomes sooner, so that the fall time of the signal OUT can be reduced. Further, as the timing at which the transistor 112 is turned off gets sooner, the time during which a flow-through current between the wirings 15 and 13 flows can be shortened, whereby power consumption can be reduced.

(73) Like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4B, the gate of the transistor 112 may be connected to the wiring 11 also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, and 4A. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4B can be attained.

(74) As shown in FIG. 5A, a transistor 115 whose first terminal is connected to the wiring 13, second terminal is connected to the gate of the transistor 111, and gate is connected to the wiring 12 may be provided in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A. The potential VL1 of the wiring

13 is supplied to the gate of the transistor **111** through the transistor **115**. The timing at which the potential **VL1** is supplied to the gate of the transistor **111** through the transistor **115** is controlled by the signal **SE** of the wiring **12**. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5A, the potential **VL1** of the wiring **13** can be supplied to the gate of the transistor **111** in the period **T0**, whereby the semiconductor device can be initialized. Accordingly, malfunction of the semiconductor device can be prevented.

(75) Further, in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5A, the first terminal of the transistor **115** may be connected to the wiring **14**. Even in that case, an operation similar to that in the case where the first terminal of the transistor **115** is connected to the wiring **13** can be performed.

(76) In the case where the timing at which the offset voltage is generated does not coincide with the timing at which initialization is performed, the gate of the transistor **115** may be connected to the wiring to which a signal for initialization is input.

(77) The transistor **115** whose first terminal is connected to the wiring **13** or the wiring **14**, second terminal is connected to the gate of the transistor **111**, and gate is connected to the wiring **12** may be provided also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, and 4B. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5A can be attained.

(78) As shown in FIG. 5B, the second terminal and the gate of the transistor **113** may be connected to a wiring **17** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A. To the wiring **17**, the potential **VH**, a potential higher than the potential **VL1** and lower than the potential **VH**, or a signal may be supplied. An example of the signal which is input to the wiring **17** is an inverted signal of the signal **IN**. Therefore, the wiring **11** may be connected to the wiring **17** with an inverter provided therebetween. In that case, the transistor **113** is turned off when the transistor **114** is turned on, whereby current can be prevented from flowing between the wiring **15** and the wiring **13**. Thus, power consumption can be reduced. Further, there is no need to make the W/L ratio of the transistor **114** sufficiently larger than that of the transistor **113**, leading to a reduction in size of the transistor.

(79) The second terminal and the gate of the transistor **113** may be connected to the wiring **17** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B, and FIG. 5A. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5B can be attained.

(80) As shown in FIG. 22A, the wiring **14** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **13**, and a capacitor **103** one electrode of which is connected to the wiring **12** and the other electrode of which is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** may be provided. The capacitor **103** holds a potential difference between the wiring **12** and the other electrode of the capacitor **101**. Further, in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 22A, the potential **VL1** of the wiring **13** is supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** through the transistor **102**. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 22A, in the period **T0**, the signal **IN** at the low level is input to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**, and the potential **VL1** of the wiring **13** is supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** through the transistor **102**. Then, the signal **SE** is changed from the high level to the low level, so that the transistor **102** is turned off, and thus the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes a potential lower than the potential **VL1** owing to the capacitive coupling with the capacitor **103**. Accordingly, the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes the potential lower than the potential **VL1** in the period **T0**, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A can be attained. Further, since the wiring **14** can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 1A. In addition, since the potential **VL2** is not used, the number of power supply potentials can be reduced.

(81) As shown in FIG. 22B, the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **11** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 22A. Also in that case, in the period **T0**, the signal **IN** at the low level can be supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** through the transistor

102, and thus an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 22A can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 22A can be attained.

(82) The capacitor **103** may be omitted in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 22A and 22B. In that case, parasitic capacitance between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **102** may be used instead of the capacitor **103**.

(83) In any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 22A and 22B, the one electrode of the capacitor **103** may be connected to a wiring other than the wiring **12**. It is preferable that a signal input to the wiring is changed from a high level to a low level after the signal SE is changed from the high level to the low level in the period T0. This is because the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** can be decreased after the transistor **102** is turned off. Further, it is preferable that the timing at which the signal input to the wiring is changed from the low level to the high level is in the period during which the signal SE is at the high level.

(84) Also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B, 5A, and 5B, the wiring **14** can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **11** or the wiring **13**, and the capacitor **103** one electrode of which is connected to the wiring **12** and the other electrode of which is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** may be provided.

(85) Further, a capacitor may be connected between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111** in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B, 5A, 5B, 22A, and 22B, though not shown. Thus, the capacitance value between the wiring **16** and the node N1 can be increased. Accordingly, in the period during which the signal IN is at the low level, the potential of the node N1 can become a higher potential than the potential of the node N1 in the case where no capacitor is provided between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111**. That is, Vgs of the transistor **111** can be increased. The drain current of the transistor **111** can be increased accordingly, which shortens the rise time of the signal OUT.

(86) Further, a MOS capacitor may be used as the capacitor **101** in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B, 5A, 5B, 22A, and 22B, though not shown. In that case, it is preferable that a gate of the transistor used as the MOS capacitor is connected to the wiring **11**, and a source or a drain of the transistor is connected to the second terminal of the transistor **102**. Thus, the capacitance value per unit area can be increased because the potential of the wiring **11** is higher than that of the second terminal of the transistor **102**.

(87) Heretofore, the semiconductor devices whose configurations are different from FIG. 1A are described.

(88) As the W/L ratio of the transistor **111** increases, the rise time of the signal OUT can be shortened. Therefore, it is preferable that the W/L ratio of the transistor **111** is the largest among the transistors in the semiconductor device. That is, it is preferable that the W/L ratio of the transistor **111** is larger than any of those of the transistors **102**, **112**, **113**, and **114**.

(89) The transistor **112** supplies a potential to a load connected to the wiring **16**, whereas the transistor **114** supplies a potential to the gate of the transistor **111**. In addition, as the W/L ratio of the transistor **112** increases, the fall time of the signal OUT can be shortened. Therefore, it is preferable that the W/L ratio of the transistor **112** is larger than that of the transistor **114**.

(90) On the other hand, there is no need to make the W/L ratio of the transistor **102**, which is used for supplying charge to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** in the period T0, large. Therefore, it is preferable that the W/L ratio of the transistor **102** is smaller than that of the transistor **112** or the transistor **114**.

(91) Further, as the capacitance value of the capacitor **101** gets larger than the total of the gate capacitance of the transistors **112** and **114**, the amplitude voltage of the signal INO can get closer to that of the signal IN. Therefore, it is preferable that the capacitance value of the capacitor **101** is larger than the total of the gate capacitance of the transistors **112** and **114**. Further or alternatively,

when the one electrode of the capacitor **101** is formed of the same material as a gate electrode of a transistor and the other electrode of the capacitor **101** is formed of the same material as a source or drain electrode of the transistor, it is preferable that the area where the two electrodes of the capacitor **101** are overlapped with each other is larger than the sum of the area where the gate and source of the transistor **112** are overlapped with each other, the area where the gate and drain of the transistor **112** are overlapped with each other, the area where the gate and source of the transistor **114** are overlapped with each other, and the area where the gate and drain of the transistor **114** are overlapped with each other.

(92) In the period **T0**, the potential **VL1** may not be supplied to the wiring **13**, so that the wiring **13** can be made in a floating state, or the potential **VH** may not be supplied to the wiring **15**, so that the wiring **15** can be made in a floating state; thus, malfunction in the period **T0** can be prevented.

(93) In the period **T1**, the potential **VL2** may not be supplied to the wiring **14**, so that the wiring **14** can be made in a floating state.

(94) A low-level signal may be input to the wiring **15** in the period during which the signal **IN** is at the high level. In that case, the transistor **113** is turned off when the transistor **114** is turned on, whereby current can be prevented from flowing between the wiring **15** and the wiring **13**. Thus, power consumption can be reduced. Further, there is no need to make the W/L ratio of the transistor **114** sufficiently larger than that of the transistor **113**, leading to a reduction in size of the transistor.

(95) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any other embodiment and the like.

Embodiment 2

(96) In this embodiment, the case where the semiconductor device which is one embodiment of the present invention is used for a flip-flop circuit included in a shift register is described. Description is made on portions different from Embodiment 1.

(97) The semiconductor device of this embodiment is described with reference to FIG. 6A. FIG. 6A is a circuit diagram of the semiconductor device of this embodiment. The semiconductor device in FIG. 6A is different from that shown in FIG. 1A in that the first terminal of the transistor **111** is connected to a wiring **23**, the gate of the transistor **113** is connected to a wiring **21**, and the one electrode of the capacitor **101** is connected to a wiring **22**.

(98) Signal **IN1** is input to the wiring **21**. The signal **IN1** is an input signal of the semiconductor device and serves as a start pulse. For example, the signal **IN1** is a digital signal whose high-level potential is **VH** and low-level potential is **VL1**. The wiring **21** transmits the signal **IN1**.

(99) Signal **IN2** is input to the wiring **22**. The signal **IN2** is an input signal of the semiconductor device and serves as a reset signal. For example, the signal **IN2** is a digital signal whose high-level potential is **VH** and low-level potential is **VL1**. The wiring **22** transmits the signal **IN2**.

(100) Signal **CK** is input to the wiring **23**. The signal **CK** is an input signal of the semiconductor device. For example, the signal **CK** is a digital signal whose high-level potential is **VH** and low-level potential is **VL1**. The signal **CK** is a clock signal whose potential is switched between the high level and the low level repeatedly. The wiring **23** transmits the signal **CK**.

(101) The wirings **21**, **22**, and **23** are also called signal lines. In particular, the wiring **23** is also called a clock signal line.

(102) Next, an example of a driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 6A is described with reference to FIG. 7. FIG. 7 is an example of a timing chart for describing the driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 6A.

(103) In a period **T0**, the signal **IN2** is set at a low level, so that the potential of the one electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes **VL1**. Further, the signal **SE** is set at the high level to turn on the transistor **102**. Consequently, the potential **VL2** of the wiring **14** is supplied to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**, so that the potential of the other electrode of the capacitor **101** becomes **VL2**. In this manner, a difference between the low-level potential **VL1** of the signal **IN2** and the potential **VL2** of the wiring **14** supplied through the transistor **102**, i.e., the difference (**VL1**–**VL2**), is held in

the capacitor **101**. The difference ($VL1-VL2$) corresponds to an offset voltage.

(104) In a period **T1**, the signal **SE** is changed to the low level to turn off the transistor **102**, whereby the other electrode of the capacitor **101** is made into the floating state. Since the capacitor **101** holds the potential difference ($VL1-VL2$) in the period **T0**, a signal obtained by subtracting the potential difference ($VL1-VL2$) from the potential of signal **IN2** is generated as a signal **IN2O**. Therefore, when the signal **IN2** is at the low level, the signal **IN2O** becomes a low level whose potential is lower than $VL1$; when the signal **IN2** is at a high level, the signal **IN2O** becomes a high level whose potential is lower than VH .

(105) The driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** in the period **T1** is described separately for each of a period **Ta**, a period **Tb**, a period **Tc**, and a period **Td**.

(106) In the period **Ta**, since the signal **IN2** is at the low level, the signal **IN2O** becomes the low level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are turned off. Further, the signal **IN1** is changed to the high level, so that the transistor **113** is turned on. Consequently, the potential VH of the wiring **15** is supplied to the node **N1**, and accordingly the potential of the node **N1** increases. Consequently, the transistor **111** is turned on, so that the signal **CK** of the wiring **23** is supplied to the wiring **16**. Since the signal **CK** is at the low level in the period **Ta**, the signal **OUT** becomes the low level whose potential is $VL1$. Then, the potential of the node **N1** reaches a potential obtained by subtracting the threshold voltage of the transistor **113** from the potential VH , so that the transistor **113** is turned off to make the node **N1** in the floating state. A potential difference between the node **N1** and the wiring **16** at the time when the transistor **113** is turned off is held between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111**.

(107) In the period **Tb**, since the signal **IN2** is kept at the low level, the signal **IN2O** is also kept at the low level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are kept off. Further, the potential of the signal **IN1** is changed to the low level, so that the transistor **113** is kept off. Therefore, the node **N1** is kept in the floating state. Since the node **N1** is kept at the potential in the period **Ta**, the transistor **111** is kept on, and thus the signal **CK** of the wiring **23** is kept supplied to the wiring **16**. In the period **Tb**, the potential of the signal **CK** is changed to the high level, so that the potential of the wiring **16** increases. In the meantime, the potential difference between the node **N1** and the wiring **16** in the period **Ta** is kept to be held between the gate and the second terminal of the transistor **111**.

Accordingly, the potential of the node **N1** further increases to be higher than the potential VH along with the increase in the potential of the wiring **16**. Accordingly, the signal **OUT** becomes the high-level potential which is VH .

(108) In the period **Tc**, the level of the signal **IN2** is changed to the high level, and thus the level of the signal **IN2O** is also changed to the high level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are turned on. Consequently, the potential $VL1$ of the wiring **13** is supplied to the wiring **16** through the transistor **112** and to the node **N1** through the transistor **114**. On the other hand, the signal **IN1** is kept at the low level, and thus the transistor **113** is kept off. Accordingly, the potential of the node **N1** is changed to the potential $VL1$, so that the transistor **111** is turned off. Accordingly, the signal **OUT** becomes the low-level potential which is $VL1$.

(109) In the period **Td**, the level of the signal **IN2** is changed to the low level, and thus the level of the signal **IN2O** is also changed to the low level, so that the transistors **112** and **114** are turned off. Further, the signal **IN1** is kept at the low level, and thus the transistor **113** is kept off. Accordingly, the node **N1** is kept at the potential $VL1$ in the period **Tc**, so that the transistor **111** is kept off. Further, the wiring **16** is kept at the potential $VL1$ in the period **Tc**, so that the signal **OUT** is kept at the low-level potential.

(110) As described above, when the signal **IN2** is at the low level, the potential of the gate of the transistor **114** is lower than $VL1$, and thus V_{gs} of the transistor **114** is a negative value; therefore, even if the transistor **114** is a depletion transistor, the transistor **114** can be turned off, or even if the transistor **114** is a transistor whose drain current at V_{gs} of 0 V is large, the drain current of the transistor **114** can be suppressed. Accordingly, the gate of the transistor **111** can be made into the

floating state, whereby malfunction of the circuit **110** can be prevented.

(111) Further, when the signal **IN2** is at the high level, the potentials of the gates of the transistors **112** and **114** are lower than V_H , and thus V_{gs} of the transistors **112** and **114** are small. Accordingly, degradation of the transistors **112** and **114** can be suppressed.

(112) Heretofore, the driving method of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** is described.

(113) Next, semiconductor devices different from FIG. **6A** are described with reference to FIGS. **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, **9A**, **9B**, and **10A**. Description is made on portions different from FIG. **6A**, below.

(114) As shown in FIG. **6B**, the first terminal of the transistor **113** may be connected to the wiring **21** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A**. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6B**, the signal **IN1** of the wiring **21** is supplied to the node **N1** through the transistor **113** in the period T_a . In the period T_a , since the signal **IN1** is at the high level, the potential of the node **N1** increases. Then, the potential of the node **N1** reaches a potential obtained by subtracting the threshold voltage of the transistor **113** from the potential V_H , so that the transistor **113** is turned off. The transistor **113** is kept off in the periods T_b , T_c , and T_d . Accordingly, an operation similar to that of the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** can be performed. Accordingly, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** can be attained. Further, since the wiring **15** can be omitted, the number of wirings can be smaller than that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A**.

(115) As shown in FIG. **8A**, the circuit **100** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6B** may be connected to the wiring **21** instead of the wiring **22**. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **8A**, the signal **IN1** of the wiring **21** connected to the circuit **100** is offset to generate a signal **IN1O** and the signal **IN1O** is supplied to the gate of the transistor **113**. The one electrode of the capacitor **101** is connected to the wiring **21**, and the other electrode thereof is connected to the gate of the transistor **113**. The first terminal of the transistor **102** is connected to the wiring **14**, the second terminal of the transistor **102** is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101**, and the gate of the transistor **102** is connected to the wiring **12**. The capacitor **101** holds a potential difference between the wiring **21** and the gate of the transistor **113**, and the transistor **102** supplies the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **14** to the gate of the transistor **113**. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **8A**, V_{gs} of the transistor **113** can be suppressed to be negative; therefore, the W/L ratio of the transistor **113** can be made large without considering the amount of charge supplied to the node **N1**. Accordingly, the time the potential of the node **N1** takes to reach the above-described potential can be shortened, increasing the driving frequency.

(116) As shown in FIG. **8B**, the circuit **100** may be provided not only for the wiring **22** but also for the wiring **21** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6B**. In FIG. **8B**, the circuit **100** provided for the wiring **22**, and the capacitor **101** and the transistor **102** included in the circuit **100** are denoted by a circuit **100A**, a capacitor **101A**, and a transistor **102A**, respectively; the circuit **100** provided for the wiring **21**, and the capacitor **101** and the transistor **102** included in the circuit **100** are denoted by a circuit **100B**, a capacitor **101B**, and a transistor **102B**, respectively. The circuit **100A** is similar to the circuit **100** shown in FIG. **6A**, and the circuit **100B** is similar to the circuit **100** shown in FIG. **8A**; therefore, description thereof is skipped. An effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6B** and an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **8A** can be attained by the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **8B**.

(117) As shown in FIG. **9A**, the gate of the transistor **112** may be connected to a wiring **24** in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A**. Signal **IN3** is input to the wiring **24**. The wiring **24** transmits the signal **IN3**. The signal **IN3** is a digital signal whose high-level potential is V_H and low-level potential is V_{L1} . As examples of the signal **IN3**, there are a clock signal which is an inverted signal of the signal **CK**, a clock signal whose phase is shifted from that of the signal **CK**, and the like. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9A**, in the period T_d , the transistor **112** is switched between on and off repeatedly, so that the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** can be supplied to the wiring **16** periodically, whereby the potential of the wiring **16** can be kept at V_{L1} more

surely.

(118) The gate of the transistor **112** may be connected to the wiring **24** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6B**, **8A**, and **8B**. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9A** can be attained.

(119) A transistor whose first terminal is connected to the wiring **13**, second terminal is connected to the wiring **16**, and gate is connected to the wiring **24** may be provided in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6A**, **6B**, **8A**, and **8B**. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9A** can be attained.

(120) As shown in FIG. **9B**, a transistor **116** whose first terminal is connected to the wiring **23**, second terminal is connected to a wiring **25**, and gate is connected to the gate of the transistor **111** may be provided in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A**. The transistor **116** supplies the signal CK of the wiring **23** to the wiring **25**. The timing at which the signal CK of the wiring **23** is supplied to the wiring **25** is controlled by the potential of the node N1. The transistor **116** also holds a potential difference between the wiring **25** and the node N1. The signal OUT is output from the wiring **25**. The wiring **25** transmits the signal OUT. In FIG. **9B**, the signal OUT output from the wiring **16** is denoted by a signal OUTA whereas the signal OUT output from the wiring **25** is denoted by a signal OUTB. The signal OUTA is switched between a high level and a low level at the same timing as the signal OUTB. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9B**, one of the signal OUTA and the signal OUTB can be used as a forward signal of the shift register and the other can be used as a signal for driving a load or the like. Accordingly, with the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9B** used in the flip-flop circuit, normal operation can be performed even when a large load is driven.

(121) The transistor **116** whose first terminal is connected to the wiring **23**, second terminal is connected to the wiring **25**, and gate is connected to the gate of the transistor **111** may be provided also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, and **9A**. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9B** can be attained.

(122) As shown in FIG. **10A**, a circuit **120** for generating the signal IN2 may be provided in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A**. The circuit **120** is connected to the node N1, the wiring **12**, and the one electrode of the capacitor **101**. The circuit **120** generates the signal IN2 in accordance with the potential of the node N1 and the signal SE of the wiring **12** and outputs to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**. For example, the circuit **120** generates the signal IN2 at the low level when the signal SE is at the high level regardless of the potential of the node N1; and when the signal SE is at the low level, the circuit **120** generates the signal IN2 at the low level when the potential of the node N1 is high (e.g., the period Ta, the period Tb) and generates the signal IN2 at the high level when the potential of the node N1 is low (e.g., the period Tc, the period Td). That is, the circuit **120** serves as a NOR circuit.

(123) The circuit **120** may be connected to the wiring **16** instead of the node N1.

(124) The circuit **120** for generating the signal IN2 may be provided also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, **9A**, and **9B**.

(125) Although not shown in the drawing, the second terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **13** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6A**, **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, **9A**, **9B**, and **10A**, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **2A**. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **2A** can be attained.

(126) Although not shown in the drawing, the second terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **15** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6A**, **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, **9A**, **9B**, and **10A**, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **2B**. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **2B** can be attained.

(127) Although not shown in the drawing, the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **12** and the gate of the transistor **102** may be connected to the second terminal of the transistor **102** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. **6A**, **6B**, **8A**, **8B**, **9A**, **9B**, and **10A**,

like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 3A. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 3A can be attained.

(128) Although not shown in the drawing, the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **13** and the gate of the transistor **102** may be connected to the second terminal of the transistor **102** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 8A, 8B, 9A, 9B, and 10A, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 3B. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 3B can be attained.

(129) Although not shown in the drawing, the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **15** and the gate of the transistor **102** may be connected to the second terminal of the transistor **102** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 8A, 8B, 9A, 9B, and 10A, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4A. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4A can be attained.

(130) Although not shown in the drawing, the gate of the transistor **112** may be connected to the one electrode of the capacitor **101** also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 8A, 8B, 9A, 9B, and 10A, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4B. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 4B can be attained.

(131) Although not shown in the drawing, the transistor **115** whose first terminal is connected to the wiring **13**, second terminal is connected to the gate of the transistor **111**, and gate is connected to the wiring **12** may be provided also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 8A, 8B, 9A, 9B, and 10A, like the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5A. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 5A can be attained.

(132) Although not shown in the drawing, the wiring **14** can be omitted, and the first terminal of the transistor **102** may be connected to the wiring **22** or the wiring **13**, and the capacitor **103** one electrode of which is connected to the wiring **12** and the other electrode of which is connected to the other electrode of the capacitor **101** may be provided also in any semiconductor device shown in FIGS. 6A, 6B, 8A, 8B, 9A, 9B, and 10A, like the semiconductor devices shown in FIGS. 22A and 22B. Also in that case, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor devices shown in FIGS. 22A and 22B can be attained.

(133) Heretofore, the semiconductor devices whose configurations are different from FIG. 6A are described.

(134) Next, a specific example of the circuit **120** is described.

(135) FIG. 10B is a circuit diagram of the circuit **120**. The circuit **120** includes a transistor **121**, a transistor **122**, and a transistor **123**. A first terminal of the transistor **121** is connected to the wiring **15**, a second terminal of the transistor **121** is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**, and a gate of the transistor **121** is connected to the wiring **15**. A first terminal of the transistor **122** is connected to the wiring **13**, a second terminal of the transistor **122** is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**, and a gate of the transistor **122** is connected to the node N1. A first terminal of the transistor **123** is connected to the wiring **13**, a second terminal of the transistor **123** is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**, and a gate of the transistor **123** is connected to the wiring **12**.

(136) The transistor **121** supplies the potential V_H of the wiring **15** to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**. The transistor **122** supplies the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**. The transistor **123** also supplies the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** to the one electrode of the capacitor **101**. The timing at which the transistor **122** supplies the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** to the one electrode of the capacitor **101** is controlled by the potential of the node N1. The timing at which the transistor **123** supplies the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** to the one electrode of the capacitor **101** is controlled by the signal SE of the wiring **12**.

(137) In the period T_0 , since the signal SE is at the high level, the transistor **123** is turned on. Consequently, regardless of whether the transistor **122** is on, the potential V_{L1} of the wiring **13** is supplied to the one electrode of the capacitor **101** through the transistor **123**, whereby the signal

IN2 becomes a low-level potential.

(138) In the period T1, since the level of the signal SE is changed to the low level, the transistor 123 is turned off. Consequently, in the case where the potential of the node N1 is increased and thus the transistor 122 is turned on, the potential VL1 of the wiring 13 is supplied to the one electrode of the capacitor 101 through the transistor 122, whereby the signal IN2 becomes the low-level potential; in the case where the potential of the node N1 is decreased and thus the transistor 122 is turned off, the potential VL1 of the wiring 13 is not supplied to the one electrode of the capacitor 101, whereby the signal IN2 becomes a high-level potential.

(139) As shown in FIG. 10C, transistors 124, 125, and 126 may be provided in the circuit 120 shown in FIG. 10B. A first terminal of the transistor 124 is connected to the wiring 15, a second terminal of the transistor 124 is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor 101, and a gate of the transistor 124 is connected to the second terminals of the transistors 121, 122, and 123. A first terminal of the transistor 125 is connected to the wiring 13, a second terminal of the transistor 125 is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor 101, and a gate of the transistor 125 is connected to the node N1. A first terminal of the transistor 126 is connected to the wiring 13, a second terminal of the transistor 126 is connected to the one electrode of the capacitor 101, and a gate of the transistor 126 is connected to the wiring 12. In the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 10C, the high-level potential and the low-level potential of the signal IN2 can be increased to VH and VL1, respectively, with a bootstrap operation.

(140) In the circuit 120 shown in FIG. 10C, the wiring 23 may be used instead of the wiring 15. That is, the first terminal of the transistor 121, the gate of the transistor 121, and the first terminal of the transistor 124 may be connected to the wiring 23. In that case, the signal IN2 can be switched between the high level and the low level repeatedly in the period Td. Accordingly, the period during which the transistors 112 and 114 are on can be shortened, whereby degradation of the transistors 112 and 114 can be suppressed.

(141) Heretofore, the specific example of the circuit 120 is described.

(142) In all or part of the period Td, the transistors 112 and 114 are turned on when the signal IN2 is set at the high level. Consequently in that case, the potential of the wiring 13 is supplied to the wiring 16 through the transistor 112 and to the node N1 through the transistor 114. Accordingly, the potentials of the wiring 16 and the node N1 can more surely be kept at VL1 also in the period Td.

(143) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any other embodiment and the like.

Embodiment 3

(144) In this embodiment, a shift register in which the semiconductor device described in Embodiment 2 is used as a flip-flop circuit is described. Description is made on portions different from Embodiments 1 and 2.

(145) The shift register of this embodiment is described with reference to FIG. 11. FIG. 11 is a circuit diagram of the shift register of this embodiment. The shift register in FIG. 11 includes N flip-flop circuits 200 (N is a natural number). Among these, 1st to 3rd stage flip-flop circuits 200 (denoted by a flip-flop circuit 200_1, a flip-flop circuit 200_2, and a flip-flop circuit 200_3) are shown in FIG. 11.

(146) In the shift register shown in FIG. 11, the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 6A is used as the flip-flop circuit 200. However, the flip-flop circuit 200 is not limited to the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 6A and any other semiconductor device described in Embodiment 2 can be used as appropriate.

(147) Connection relations in the shift register circuit shown in FIG. 11 are described. The i-th stage flip-flop circuit 200 (i is any of 2 to (N-1)) is connected to the i-th stage wiring 31 (denoted by a wiring 31_i), the (i-1)th stage wiring 31 (denoted by a wiring 31_(i-1)), the (i+1)th stage wiring 31 (denoted by a wiring 31_(i+1)), a wiring 32, a wiring 33, a wiring 34, one of wirings 35 and 36, and a wiring 37. Specifically, in the i-th stage flip-flop circuit 200, the wiring 16 is

connected to the i-th stage wiring **31**, the wiring **21** is connected to the (i-1)th stage wiring **31**, and the wiring **22** is connected to the (i+1)th stage wiring **31**. Further, the wiring **15** is connected to the wiring **32**, the wiring **13** is connected to the wiring **33**, the wiring **14** is connected to the wiring **34**, the wiring **23** is connected to one of the wirings **35** and **36**, and the wiring **12** is connected to the wiring **37**. The 1st stage flip-flop circuit **200** is different from the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** in that the wiring **21** is connected to a wiring **38**.

(148) The signal OUT is output from the wiring **31**; the wiring **31** transmits the signal OUT.

(149) The potential VH is supplied to the wiring **32**, and the wiring **32** transmits the potential VH.

(150) The potential VL1 is supplied to the wiring **33**, and the wiring **33** transmits the potential VL1.

(151) The potential VL2 is supplied to the wiring **34**, and the wiring **34** transmits the potential VL2.

(152) Signal CK1 is supplied to the wiring **35**, and the wiring **35** transmits the signal CK1. Signal CK2 is supplied to the wiring **36**, and the wiring **36** transmits the signal CK2. The signals CK1 and CK2 are similar to the signal CK. The signals CK1 and CK2 are signals inverted from each other or signals whose phases are different from each other.

(153) The signal SE is input to the wiring **37**, and the wiring **37** transmits the signal SE.

(154) Signal SP is input to the wiring **38**, and the wiring **38** transmits the signal SP. The signal SP is a start pulse of the shift register. The signal SP is also a digital signal whose high-level potential is VH and low-level potential is VL1.

(155) Next, an example of a driving method of the shift register shown in FIG. **11** is described with reference to FIG. **12**. FIG. **12** is an example of a timing chart for describing the driving method of the shift register shown in FIG. **11**. In FIG. **12**, the signal OUT of the 1st stage flip-flop circuit **200**, the signal OUT of the 2nd stage flip-flop circuit **200**, and the signal OUT of the N-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** are denoted by a signal OUT1, a signal OUT2, and a signal OUTN, respectively.

(156) In the period T0, the signal SE is set at the high level. Consequently, each of the 1st to N-th stage flip-flop circuits **200** performs the operation as in the period T0 described in Embodiment 2.

(157) In the period T1, the level of the signal SE is changed to the low level. Consequently, each of the 1st to N-th stage flip-flop circuits **200** performs the operation as in the period T1 described in Embodiment 2. Specifically, when the signal OUT of the (i-1)th stage flip-flop circuit **200** is at the high level, the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** performs the operation as in the period Ta described in Embodiment 2, whereby the signal OUT of the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** comes to be at the low level. Then, the signals CK1 and CK2 are inverted, and the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** performs the operation as in the period Tb described in Embodiment 2, whereby the signal OUT of the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** comes to be at the high level. Then, the signals CK1 and CK2 are inverted and the signal OUT of the (i+1)th stage flip-flop circuit **200** is changed to the high level, and the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** performs the operation as in the period Tc described in Embodiment 2, whereby the signal OUT of the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** comes to be at the low level. Then, until the signal OUT of the (i-1)th stage flip-flop circuit **200** is changed to the high level again, the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** keeps performing the operation in the period Td described in Embodiment 2, in which the signal OUT of the i-th stage flip-flop circuit **200** is kept at the low level.

(158) Since the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** is used as the flip-flop circuit **200** in the shift register shown in FIG. **11**, an effect similar to that in the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **6A** can be attained.

(159) Heretofore, the driving method of the shift register shown in FIG. **11** is described.

(160) In the shift register shown in FIG. **11**, the wiring **37** can be omitted and the wiring **12** in each flip-flop circuit **200** may be connected to the wiring **38**. In this manner, the number of wirings can be reduced. In addition, the offset voltage can be held periodically in the capacitor **101**.

(161) In the case where the semiconductor device shown in FIG. **9A** is used for the flip-flop circuit **200**, the wiring **24** is preferably connected to the wiring **36** when the wiring **23** is connected to the wiring **35**. In this manner, an increase in the number of wirings can be suppressed.

(162) In the case where the semiconductor device shown in FIG. 9B is used for the flip-flop circuit **200**, it is preferable that the wiring **25** is connected to the wiring **31** and the wiring **16** is connected to a load. In this manner, another stage flip-flop circuit **200** can be driven by the signal OUTB of the wiring **25**, which is not affected by the load, whereby the shift register can be driven stably.

(163) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any other embodiment and the like.

Embodiment 4

(164) In this embodiment, a display device in which the shift register described in Embodiment 3 is used for a driver circuit is described.

(165) Further, part or whole of the driver circuit can be formed over the same substrate as a pixel portion, whereby a system-on-panel can be obtained.

(166) As a display element used for the display device, a liquid crystal element (also referred to as a liquid crystal display element) or a light-emitting element (also referred to as a light-emitting display element) can be used. The light-emitting element includes in its category, an element whose luminance is controlled by a current or a voltage, and specifically includes an inorganic electroluminescent (EL) element, an organic EL element, and the like. A display medium whose contrast is changed by an electric effect, such as electronic ink, can also be used.

(167) In FIG. **13A**, a sealant **4005** is provided so as to surround a pixel portion **4002** provided over a first substrate **4001**, and the pixel portion **4002** is sealed between the first substrate **4001** and a second substrate **4006**. In FIG. **13A**, a scan line driver circuit **4004** and a signal line driver circuit **4003** are formed over another substrate and mounted in a region outside a region surrounded by the sealant **4005** over the first substrate **4001**. Further, a variety of signals and potentials are supplied to the signal line driver circuit **4003**, the scan line driver circuit **4004**, and the pixel portion **4002** from flexible printed circuits (FPCs) **4018a** and **4018b**.

(168) In FIGS. **13B** and **13C**, the sealant **4005** is provided so as to surround the pixel portion **4002** and the scan line driver circuit **4004** which are provided over the first substrate **4001**. The second substrate **4006** is provided over the pixel portion **4002** and the scan line driver circuit **4004**. Thus, the pixel portion **4002** and the scan line driver circuit **4004** are sealed together with the display element, by the first substrate **4001**, the sealing material **4005**, and the second substrate **4006**. In FIGS. **13B** and **13C**, the signal line driver circuit **4003** is formed over another substrate and mounted in a region outside a region surrounded by the sealant **4005** over the first substrate **4001**. In FIGS. **13B** and **13C**, a variety of signals and potentials are supplied to the signal line driver circuit **4003**, the scan line driver circuit **4004**, and the pixel portion **4002** from an FPC **4018**.

(169) Although FIGS. **13B** and **13C** each illustrate an example in which the signal line driver circuit **4003** is formed separately and mounted on the first substrate **4001**, one embodiment of the present invention is not limited to this structure. The scan line driver circuit may be separately formed and then mounted, or only part of the signal line driver circuit or part of the scan line driver circuit may be separately formed and then mounted.

(170) A connection method of such a separately formed driver circuit is not particularly limited; a chip on glass (COG) method, a wire bonding method, a tape automated bonding (TAB) method, or the like can be used. FIG. **13A** illustrates an example in which the signal line driver circuit **4003** and the scan line driver circuit **4004** are mounted by a COG method; FIG. **13B** illustrates an example in which the signal line driver circuit **4003** is mounted by a COG method; FIG. **13C** illustrates an example in which the signal line driver circuit **4003** is mounted by a TAB method.

(171) In addition, the display device encompasses a panel in which the display element is sealed, and a module in which an IC or the like including a controller is mounted on the panel.

(172) The display device in this specification means an image display device, a display device, or a light source (including a lighting device). Furthermore, the display device also includes the following modules in its category: a module to which a connector such as an FPC, a TAB tape, or a TCP is attached; a module having a TAB tape or a TCP at the tip of which a printed wiring board is

provided; and a module in which an integrated circuit (IC) is directly mounted on a display element by a COG method.

(173) The pixel portion provided over the first substrate includes a plurality of transistors.

(174) In the case where a liquid crystal element is used as the display element, a thermotropic liquid crystal, a low-molecular liquid crystal, a high-molecular liquid crystal, a polymer dispersed liquid crystal, a ferroelectric liquid crystal, an antiferroelectric liquid crystal, or the like is used. Such a liquid crystal material exhibits a cholesteric phase, a smectic phase, a cubic phase, a chiral nematic phase, an isotropic phase, or the like, depending on conditions.

(175) Alternatively, liquid crystal exhibiting a blue phase for which an alignment film is unnecessary may be used. The blue phase is one of liquid crystal phases, which is generated just before a cholesteric phase changes into an isotropic phase while the temperature of the cholesteric liquid crystal is increased. Since the blue phase appears only in a narrow temperature range, a liquid crystal composition in which 5 wt. % or more of a chiral agent is mixed is preferably used for a liquid crystal layer in order to improve the temperature range. The liquid crystal composition which includes a liquid crystal exhibiting a blue phase and a chiral agent has a short response time of 1 msec or less, has optical isotropy, which makes the alignment process unneeded, and has a small viewing angle dependence. In addition, since the alignment film does not need to be provided, rubbing treatment is not necessary. Consequently, electrostatic discharge caused by the rubbing treatment can be prevented and thus defects and damage of the liquid crystal display device in the manufacturing process can be reduced. Accordingly, productivity of the liquid crystal display device can be increased.

(176) The specific resistivity of the liquid crystal material is greater than or equal to $1 \times 10^9 \Omega \cdot \text{cm}$, preferably greater than or equal to $1 \times 10^{11} \Omega \cdot \text{cm}$, further preferably greater than or equal to $1 \times 10^{12} \Omega \cdot \text{cm}$. The specific resistivity in this specification is measured at 20° C.

(177) The size of a storage capacitor provided in the liquid crystal display device is set considering the leakage current of the transistor provided in the pixel portion or the like so that charge can be retained for a predetermined period. The size of the storage capacitor may be set considering the off-state current of the transistor or the like.

(178) For the liquid crystal display device, a twisted nematic (TN) mode, an in-plane-switching (IPS) mode, a fringe field switching (FFS) mode, an axially symmetric aligned micro-cell (ASM) mode, an optical compensated birefringence (OCB) mode, a ferroelectric liquid crystal (FLC) mode, an antiferroelectric liquid crystal (AFLC) mode, or the like is used.

(179) Further, a normally black liquid crystal display device such as a transmissive liquid crystal display device utilizing a vertical alignment (VA) mode may be formed. Some examples are given as the vertical alignment mode; for example, a multi-domain vertical alignment (MVA) mode, a patterned vertical alignment (PVA) mode, an ASV mode, or the like can be used.

(180) This embodiment can also be applied to a VA liquid crystal display device. The VA liquid crystal display device has a kind of form in which alignment of liquid crystal molecules of a liquid crystal display panel is controlled. In the VA liquid crystal display device, liquid crystal molecules are aligned in a vertical direction with respect to a panel surface when no voltage is applied. Moreover, it is possible to use a method called domain multiplication or multi-domain design, in which a pixel is divided into some regions (subpixels) and molecules are aligned in different directions in their respective regions.

(181) In the display device, a black matrix (light-blocking layer), an optical member (optical substrate) such as a polarizing member, a retardation member, or an anti-reflection member, and the like are provided as appropriate. For example, circular polarization with a polarizing substrate and a retardation substrate may be used. In addition, a backlight, a side light, or the like may be used as a light source.

(182) As a display method in the pixel portion, a progressive method, an interlace method, or the

like can be used. Further, color elements controlled in a pixel for color display are not limited to three colors: R, G, and B (R, G, and B correspond to red, green, and blue, respectively). For example, R, G, B, and W (W corresponds to white); R, G, B, and one or more of yellow, cyan, magenta, and the like; or the like can be used. Further, the size of a display region may be different between respective dots of color elements. The present invention is not limited to the application to a display device for color display; one embodiment of the present invention can be applied to a display device for monochrome display.

(183) Alternatively, as the display element included in the display device, a light-emitting element utilizing electroluminescence can be used. Light-emitting elements utilizing electroluminescence are classified according to whether the light-emitting material is an organic compound or an inorganic compound. In general, the former is referred to as an organic EL element, and the latter is referred to as an inorganic EL element.

(184) In the organic EL element, by application of voltage to the light-emitting element, electrons and holes are separately injected from a pair of electrodes into a layer containing a light-emitting organic compound, and current flows. The carriers (electrons and holes) are recombined, and thus, the light-emitting organic compound is excited. The light-emitting organic compound returns to a ground state from the excited state, thereby emitting light. The light-emitting element is called a current-excitation light-emitting element after such a mechanism.

(185) The inorganic EL elements are classified according to their element structures into a dispersion-type inorganic EL element and a thin-film inorganic EL element. The dispersion-type inorganic EL element has a light-emitting layer where particles of a light-emitting material are dispersed in a binder, and its light emission mechanism is donor-acceptor recombination type light emission that utilizes a donor level and an acceptor level. The thin-film inorganic EL element has a structure where a light-emitting layer is sandwiched between dielectric layers, which are further sandwiched between electrodes, and its light emission mechanism is localized type light emission that utilizes inner-shell electron transition of metal ions.

(186) Further, an electronic paper in which electronic ink is driven can be provided as the display device. The electronic paper is also called an electrophoretic display device (electrophoretic display) and has advantages in that it has the same level of readability as regular paper, it has less power consumption than other display devices, and it can be shaped thin and light.

(187) Although the electrophoretic display device can have various modes, the electrophoretic display device contains a plurality of microcapsules dispersed in a solvent or a solute, each microcapsule containing first particles which are positively charged and second particles which are negatively charged. By applying an electric field to the microcapsules, the particles in the microcapsules move in opposite directions to each other and only the color of the particles gathering on one side is displayed. The first particle and the second particle each contain pigment and do not move without an electric field. Further, the first particle and the second particle have different colors (one of them may be colorless).

(188) Thus, the electrophoretic display device is a display device that utilizes a so-called dielectrophoretic effect by which a substance having a high dielectric constant moves to a high-electric field region.

(189) A solution in which the above microcapsules are dispersed in a solvent is referred to as electronic ink. This electronic ink can be printed on a surface of glass, plastic, cloth, paper, or the like. Furthermore, the electronic ink also enables color display with a color filter or particles that have a pigment.

(190) The first particle and the second particle in the microcapsules may be formed using a single material selected from a conductive material, an insulating material, a semiconductor material, a magnetic material, a liquid crystal material, a ferroelectric material, an electroluminescent material, an electrochromic material, or a magnetophoretic material or formed using a composite material of any of these.

(191) As the electronic paper, a display device using a twisting ball display system can be used. The twisting ball display system refers to a method in which spherical particles each colored in black and white are arranged between a first electrode layer and a second electrode layer which are electrode layers used for a display element, and a potential difference is generated between the first electrode layer and the second electrode layer to control orientation of the spherical particles, so that display is performed.

(192) The shift register described in Embodiment 3 can be applied to the display device described in this embodiment, whereby a display device which can operate stably even if the transistor is a depletion transistor can be provided.

(193) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any other embodiment and the like.

Embodiment 5

(194) In this embodiment, a transistor applicable to any of the semiconductor devices described in Embodiments 1 and 2, the shift register described in Embodiment 3, and the display device described in Embodiment 4 is described.

(195) <Oxide Semiconductor>

(196) An oxide semiconductor is described below in detail.

(197) An oxide semiconductor to be used preferably contains at least indium (In) or zinc (Zn). In particular, In and Zn are preferably contained. As a stabilizer for reducing variation in electric characteristics of a transistor using the oxide semiconductor, gallium (Ga) is preferably further contained. Tin (Sn) is preferably contained as a stabilizer. Hafnium (Hf) is preferably contained as a stabilizer. Aluminum (Al) is preferably contained as a stabilizer.

(198) As another stabilizer, one or plural kinds of lanthanoid such as lanthanum (La), cerium (Ce), praseodymium (Pr), neodymium (Nd), samarium (Sm), europium (Eu), gadolinium (Gd), terbium (Tb), dysprosium (Dy), holmium (Ho), erbium (Er), thulium (Tm), ytterbium (Yb), and lutetium (Lu) may be contained.

(199) As the oxide semiconductor, for example, any of the following can be used: an indium oxide, a tin oxide, a zinc oxide, a two-component metal oxide such as an In—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Zn-based oxide, an Al—Zn-based oxide, a Zn—Mg-based oxide, a Sn—Mg-based oxide, an In—Mg-based oxide, or an In—Ga-based oxide, a three-component metal oxide such as an In—Ga—Zn-based oxide (also referred to as IGZO), an In—Al—Zn-based oxide, an In—Sn—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Ga—Zn-based oxide, an Al—Ga—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Al—Zn-based oxide, an In—Hf—Zn-based oxide, an In—La—Zn-based oxide, an In—Ce—Zn-based oxide, an In—Pr—Zn-based oxide, an In—Nd—Zn-based oxide, an In—Sm—Zn-based oxide, an In—Eu—Zn-based oxide, an In—Gd—Zn-based oxide, an In—Tb—Zn-based oxide, an In—Dy—Zn-based oxide, an In—Ho—Zn-based oxide, an In—Er—Zn-based oxide, an In—Tm—Zn-based oxide, an In—Yb—Zn-based oxide, or an In—Lu—Zn-based oxide, and a four-component metal oxide such as an In—Sn—Ga—Zn-based oxide, an In—Hf—Ga—Zn-based oxide, an In—Al—Ga—Zn-based oxide, an In—Sn—Al—Zn-based oxide, an In—Sn—Hf—Zn-based oxide, or an In—Hf—Al—Zn-based oxide.

(200) An In—Ga—Zn-based oxide semiconductor material has sufficiently high resistance when there is no electric field and thus has a sufficiently low off-state current. In addition, the In—Ga—Zn-based oxide semiconductor material has a high field-effect mobility. Further, in a transistor using an In—Sn—Zn-based oxide semiconductor material, the field-effect mobility can be three times or more as high as that of a transistor using the In—Ga—Zn-based oxide semiconductor material, and the threshold voltage is likely to be positive. These semiconductor materials are appropriate examples of a material that can be used for a transistor included in a semiconductor device according to one embodiment of the present invention

(201) For example, the “In—Ga—Zn-based oxide” means an oxide containing In, Ga, and Zn as its main components and there is no particular limitation on the ratio of In:Ga:Zn. The In—Ga—Zn-based oxide may contain a metal element other than the In, Ga, and Zn.

(202) Alternatively, a material represented by $\text{InMO.sub.3(ZnO).sub.m}$ ($m>0$ and $m\neq\text{an integer}$) may be used as the oxide semiconductor. Note that M represents one or more metal elements selected from Ga, Fe, Mn, and Co. Further alternatively, as the oxide semiconductor, a material represented by $\text{In.sub.3SnO.sub.5(ZnO).sub.n}$ ($n>0$ and $n=\text{an integer}$) may be used.

(203) For example, an In—Ga—Zn-based oxide with an atomic ratio of $\text{In:Ga:Zn}=1:1:1$ ($=\frac{1}{3}:\frac{1}{3}:\frac{1}{3}$) or $\text{In:Ga:Zn}=2:2:1$ ($=\frac{2}{5}:\frac{2}{5}:\frac{1}{5}$), or any of oxides whose composition is in the neighborhood of the above compositions can be used. Alternatively, an In—Sn—Zn-based oxide with an atomic ratio of $\text{In:Sn:Zn}=1:1:1$ ($=\frac{1}{3}:\frac{1}{3}:\frac{1}{3}$), $\text{In:Sn:Zn}=2:1:3$ ($=\frac{1}{3}:\frac{1}{6}:\frac{1}{2}$), or $\text{In:Sn:Zn}=2:1:5$ ($=\frac{1}{4}:\frac{1}{8}:\frac{5}{8}$), or any of oxides whose composition is in the neighborhood of the above compositions may be used.

(204) However, without limitation to the materials given above, a material with an appropriate composition may be used depending on needed semiconductor characteristics (e.g., mobility, threshold voltage, and variation). In order to realize the needed semiconductor characteristics, it is preferable that the carrier density, the impurity concentration, the defect density, the atomic ratio between a metal element and oxygen, the interatomic distance, the density, and the like be set to appropriate values.

(205) For example, a high mobility can be provided relatively easily with the In—Sn—Zn-based oxide, whereas the mobility can be increased by reducing the defect density in the bulk also with the In—Ga—Zn-based oxide.

(206) For example, the case where the composition of an oxide having an atomic ratio of $\text{In:Ga:Zn}=a:b:c$ ($a+b+c=1$) is in the neighborhood of the composition of an oxide having an atomic ratio of $\text{In:Ga:Zn}=A:B:C$ ($A+B+C=1$) means that a , b , and c satisfy the following relation: $(a-A).\text{sup.}2+(b-B).\text{sup.}2+(c-C).\text{sup.}2\leq r.\text{sup.}2$, and r may be 0.05, for example. The same can be applied to other oxides.

(207) Further, it is preferable that impurities such as moisture and hydrogen, which form an electron donor (donor), be reduced, so that an oxide semiconductor layer can be highly purified. Specifically, the concentration of hydrogen in the highly-purified oxide semiconductor layer that is measured by secondary ion mass spectrometry (SIMS) is $5\times 10^{19}/\text{cm}^3$ or less, preferably $5\times 10^{18}/\text{cm}^3$ or less, further preferably $5\times 10^{17}/\text{cm}^3$ or less, still further preferably $1\times 10^{16}/\text{cm}^3$ or less. The carrier density of the oxide semiconductor layer measured by Hall effect measurement is less than $1\times 10^{14}/\text{cm}^3$, preferably less than $1\times 10^{12}/\text{cm}^3$, further preferably less than $1\times 10^{11}/\text{cm}^3$.

(208) Here, an analysis on the hydrogen concentration of the oxide semiconductor layer is mentioned. The hydrogen concentration of the semiconductor layer is measured by secondary ion mass spectrometry. It is known that it is difficult, in principle, to obtain correct data in the proximity of a top surface of a sample or in the proximity of an interface between stacked layers formed of different materials by the SIMS analysis. Thus, in the case where the distribution of the concentration of hydrogen in the layer in a thickness direction is analyzed by SIMS, an average value is obtained in a region of the layer in which the concentration is not greatly changed and is kept substantially the same value, and is employed as the hydrogen concentration. However, in the case where the thickness of the layer is small, such a region where the concentration is kept substantially the same value cannot be found in some cases due to the influence of the concentration of hydrogen in an adjacent layer. In that case, the maximum value or the minimum value of the hydrogen concentration in the region of the layer is employed as the hydrogen concentration of the layer. Further, in the case where a mountain-shaped peak having the maximum value or a valley-shaped peak having the minimum value does not appear in the region of the layer, the value at an inflection point is employed as the hydrogen concentration.

(209) In the case where the oxide semiconductor layer is formed by a sputtering method, it is important to reduce not only the hydrogen concentration of a target but also water and hydrogen in a chamber, as much as possible. Specifically, the following are effective: inside of the chamber is baked before the deposition; the water and hydrogen concentrations in a gas introduced in the

chamber are reduced; and counter flow of an exhaust system, from which a gas in the chamber is exhausted, is prevented.

(210) The oxide semiconductor may be either single crystal or non-single-crystal. In the latter case, the oxide semiconductor may be either amorphous or polycrystal. Further, the oxide semiconductor may have either an amorphous structure including a portion having crystallinity or a non-amorphous structure.

(211) In an oxide semiconductor in an amorphous state, a flat surface can be obtained with relative ease, so that when a transistor is manufactured with the use of the oxide semiconductor, interface scattering can be reduced, and thus relatively high mobility can be obtained with relative ease.

(212) On the other hand, in an oxide semiconductor having crystallinity, defects in the bulk can be further reduced and when the surface flatness is improved, mobility higher than that of the oxide semiconductor layer in an amorphous state can be obtained. To improve the surface flatness, the oxide semiconductor is preferably formed on a flat surface; specifically, the oxide semiconductor may be formed on a surface with an average surface roughness (Ra) of less than or equal to 1 nm, preferably less than or equal to 0.3 nm, further preferably less than or equal to 0.1 nm.

(213) Note that $R_{a.s}$ is obtained by three-dimension expansion of a center line average roughness that is defined by HS B 0601 so as to be applied to a plane, and can be expressed as an “average value of the absolute values of deviations from a reference surface to a specified surface” and is defined by the formula below.

$$(214) \quad R_a = \frac{1}{S_0} \int_{y_1}^{y_2} \int_{x_1}^{x_2} |f(x, y) - Z_0| \cdot dx dy \quad [\text{FORMULA1}]$$

(215) In the above formula, S_0 represents the area of a plane to be measured (a rectangular region which is defined by four points at coordinates (x.sub.1, y.sub.1), (x.sub.1, y.sub.2), (x.sub.2, y.sub.1), and (x.sub.2, y.sub.2)), and Z_0 represents the average height of the plane to be measured. The average surface roughness R_a can be measured with an atomic force microscope (AFM).

(216) The oxide semiconductor film is in a single crystal state, a polycrystalline (also referred to as polycrystal) state, an amorphous state, or the like.

(217) The oxide semiconductor film is preferably a c-axis aligned crystalline oxide semiconductor (CAAC-OS) film.

(218) The CAAC-OS film is not either complete single crystal or complete amorphous. The CAAC-OS film is an oxide semiconductor film with a crystal-amorphous mixed phase structure where crystal parts and amorphous parts are included in an amorphous phase. Note that in many cases, the crystal part has a size fits inside a cube whose side is less than 100 nm. From an observation image obtained with a transmission electron microscope (TEM), a boundary between the amorphous part and the crystal part in the CAAC-OS film is not clear. Further, with the TEM, a grain boundary in the CAAC-OS film is not found; thus, in the CAAC-OS film, a decrease in electron mobility due to the grain boundary is suppressed.

(219) In each of the crystal parts included in the CAAC-OS film, a c-axis is aligned in a direction parallel to a normal vector of a surface where the CAAC-OS film is formed or a normal vector of a top surface of the CAAC-OS film, triangular or hexagonal atomic arrangement which is seen from the direction perpendicular to the a-b plane is formed, and metal atoms are arranged in a layered manner or metal atoms and oxygen atoms are arranged in a layered manner when seen from the direction perpendicular to the c-axis. The directions of the a-axis and the b-axis of the crystal part may be different among the crystal parts. In this specification, the simple expression “perpendicular” encompasses a range from 85° to 95°; the simple expression “parallel” encompasses a range from -5° to 5°.

(220) In the CAAC-OS film, distribution of the crystal parts is not necessarily uniform. For example, in the case where crystal growth proceeds from a top surface side of the oxide semiconductor film in forming the CAAC-OS film, the proportion of crystal parts in the vicinity of

the top surface of the oxide semiconductor film is higher than that in the vicinity of the surface where the oxide semiconductor film is formed in some cases. Further, in the case where an impurity is added to the CAAC-OS film, the crystal part in a region to which the impurity is added becomes amorphous in some cases.

(221) Since the c-axes of the crystal parts included in the CAAC-OS film are aligned in the direction parallel to the normal vector of the surface where the CAAC-OS film is formed or the normal vector of the top surface of the CAAC-OS film, the directions of the c-axes may be different from each other depending on the shape of the CAAC-OS film (the cross-sectional shape of the surface where the CAAC-OS film is formed or the cross-sectional shape of the top surface of the CAAC-OS film). The direction of the c-axis of the crystal part is the direction parallel to the normal vector of the surface where the CAAC-OS film is formed or the normal vector of the top surface of the CAAC-OS film as it is deposited. The crystal part is formed by deposition or by performing treatment for crystallization such as heat treatment after deposition.

(222) With the use of the CAAC-OS film in the transistor, change in the electric characteristics of the transistor due to irradiation with visible light or ultraviolet light can be decreased. Thus, the transistor has high reliability.

(223) Part of oxygen included in the oxide semiconductor film may be substituted with nitrogen.

(224) Note that the proportion of oxygen gas in an atmosphere is preferably high when the CAAC-OS film is deposited by a sputtering method. For example, in the case of a sputtering method in a mixed gas atmosphere of argon and oxygen, the proportion of oxygen gas is preferably 30% or more, further preferably 40% or more. This is because oxygen is supplied from the atmosphere and promotes the crystallization of the CAAC.

(225) Further, in the case where the CAAC-OS film is deposited by a sputtering method, a substrate over which the CAAC-OS film is deposited is preferably heated to 150° C. or higher, further preferably to 170° C. or higher. This is because the higher the substrate temperature is, the more the crystallization of the CAAC is promoted.

(226) Further, after being subjected to heat treatment in a nitrogen atmosphere or in vacuum, the CAAC-OS film is preferably subjected to heat treatment in an oxygen atmosphere or a mixed atmosphere of oxygen and another gas. This is because oxygen vacancies due to the former heat treatment can be repaired by oxygen supplied from the atmosphere in the latter heat treatment.

(227) Further, the film surface on which the CAAC-OS film (deposition surface) is deposited is preferably flat. This is because roughness of the deposition surface leads to generation of grain boundaries in the CAAC-OS film because the c-axis approximately perpendicular to the deposition surface exists in the CAAC-OS film. For this reason, the deposition surface is preferably subjected to planarization such as chemical mechanical polishing (CMP) before the CAAC-OS film is deposited. The average roughness of the deposition surface is preferably 0.5 nm or less, further preferably 0.3 nm or less.

(228) Next, examples of a crystal structure of the CAAC-OS film are described in detail with reference to FIGS. 14A to 14E, FIGS. 15A to 15C, and FIGS. 16A to 16C. Unless otherwise specified, the upward direction corresponds to the c-axis direction and a plane perpendicular to the c-axis direction corresponds to the a-b plane in FIGS. 14A to 14E, FIGS. 15A to 15C, and FIGS. 16A to 16C. The simple expressions of “upper half” and “lower half” refer to an upper half above the a-b plane and a lower half below the a-b plane (an upper half and a lower half with respect to the a-b plane), respectively. Further, in FIGS. 14A to 14E, circled O surrounded represents tetracoordinate O and double-circled O represents tricoordinate O.

(229) FIG. 14A illustrates a structure including one hexacoordinate In atom and six tetracoordinate oxygen atoms (hereinafter referred to as tetracoordinate O) proximate to the In atom. Here, a structure including one metal atom and oxygen atoms proximate thereto is referred to as a small group. The structure in FIG. 14A is actually an octahedral structure, but is illustrated as a planar structure for simplicity. Note that three tetracoordinate O exist in each of an upper half and a lower

half in FIG. 14A. Electric charge of the small group illustrated in FIG. 14A is 0.

(230) FIG. 14B illustrates a structure including one pentacoordinate Ga, three tricoordinate oxygen atoms (hereinafter referred to as tricoordinate O) proximate to the Ga, and two tetracoordinate O proximate to the Ga. All the tricoordinate O exist on the a-b plane. One tetracoordinate O exists in each of an upper half and a lower half in FIG. 14B. An In atom can also have the structure illustrated in FIG. 14B because the In can have five ligands. Electric charge of the small group illustrated in FIG. 14B is 0.

(231) FIG. 14C illustrates a structure including one tetracoordinate Zn and four tetracoordinate O proximate to the Zn. In FIG. 14C, one tetracoordinate O exists in an upper half and three tetracoordinate O exist in a lower half; alternatively, three tetracoordinate O may exist in the upper half and one tetracoordinate O may exist in the lower half. Electric charge of the small group illustrated in FIG. 14C is 0.

(232) FIG. 14D illustrates a structure including one hexacoordinate Sn and six tetracoordinate O proximate to the Sn atom. In FIG. 14D, three tetracoordinate O exist in each of an upper half and a lower half. Electric charge of the small group illustrated in FIG. 14D is +1.

(233) FIG. 14E illustrates a small group including two Zn. In FIG. 14E, one tetracoordinate O exists in each of an upper half and a lower half. Electric charge of the small group illustrated in FIG. 14E is -1.

(234) Here, a plurality of small groups is collectively referred to a medium group, and a plurality of medium groups is collectively referred to as a large group (also referred to as a unit cell).

(235) Here, a rule of bonding between the small groups is described below. In FIG. 14A, the three O in the upper half with respect to the hexacoordinate In each have three proximate In in the downward direction, and the three O in the lower half each have three proximate In in the upward direction. In FIG. 14B, the one O in the upper half with respect to the pentacoordinate Ga has one proximate Ga in the downward direction, and the one O in the lower half has one proximate Ga in the upward direction. In FIG. 14C, the one O in the upper half with respect to the tetracoordinate Zn has one proximate Zn in the downward direction, and the three O in the lower half each have three proximate Zn in the upward direction. In this manner, the number of tetracoordinate O in the upper half with respect to a metal atom is equal to the number of metal atoms proximate thereto in the downward direction, and the number of tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the metal atom is equal to the number of metal atoms proximate thereto in the upward direction. Since the coordination number of the tetracoordinate O is 4, the sum of the number of the proximate metal atoms in the downward direction and the number of the proximate metal atoms in the upward direction is 4. Accordingly, when the sum of the number of tetracoordinate O in the upper half with respect to a metal atom and the number of tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to another metal atom is 4, the two small groups including the metal atoms can be bonded. The reason is described below. For example, in the case where the hexacoordinate metal (In or Sn) atom is bonded through three tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the hexacoordinate metal atom, the hexacoordinate metal atom is bonded to a pentacoordinate metal (Ga or In) atom or a tetracoordinate metal (Zn) atom.

(236) A metal atom whose coordination number is 4, 5, or 6 is bonded to another metal atom through tetracoordinate O in the c-axis direction. In addition to the above, a medium group can be formed by bonding a plurality of small groups so that the total electric charge of the layered structure is 0.

(237) FIG. 15A illustrates a model of a medium group included in a layered structure of an In—Sn—Zn—O-based system. FIG. 15B illustrates a large group consisting of three medium groups. FIG. 15C illustrates an atomic arrangement in the layered structure in FIG. 15B when observed from the c-axis direction.

(238) In FIG. 15A, tricoordinate O is omitted for simplicity, and with respect to tetracoordinate O, only the number thereof is illustrated; for example, three tetracoordinate O existing in each of an

upper half and a lower half with respect to Sn are denoted by circled 3. Similarly, in FIG. 15A, one tetracoordinate O existing in each of an upper half and a lower half with respect to In is denoted by circled 1. FIG. 15A also illustrates Zn proximate to one tetracoordinate O in the lower half and three tetracoordinate O in the upper half, and Zn proximate to one tetracoordinate O atom in the upper half and three tetracoordinate O in the lower half.

(239) In the medium group included in the layered structure of the In—Sn—Zn—O-based system in FIG. 15A, in the order starting from the top, Sn proximate to three tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half is bonded to In proximate to one tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half, the In is bonded to Zn proximate to three tetracoordinate O in the upper half, the Zn is bonded to In proximate to three tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half through one tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the Zn, the In is bonded to a small group that includes two Zn atoms and is proximate to one tetracoordinate O in the upper half, and the small group is bonded to Sn proximate to three tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half through one tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the small group. A plurality of such medium groups is bonded to constitute the large group.

(240) Here, electric charge for one bond of one tricoordinate O and electric charge for one bond of one tetracoordinate O can be assumed to be -0.667 and -0.5 , respectively. For example, electric charge of (hexacoordinate or pentacoordinate) In, electric charge of (tetracoordinate) Zn, and electric charge of (pentacoordinate or hexacoordinate) Sn are $+3$, $+2$, and $+4$, respectively.

Accordingly, electric charge in a small group including Sn is $+1$. Therefore, electric charge of -1 , which cancels $+1$, is needed to form a layered structure including Sn. As a structure having electric charge of -1 , the small group including two Zn as illustrated in FIG. 14E can be given. For example, with one small group including two Zn, electric charge of one small group including Sn can be cancelled, so that the total electric charge of the layered structure can become 0.

(241) An In—Sn—Zn—O-based crystal (In.sub.2SnZn.sub.3O.sub.8) can be obtained by repeating the large group illustrated in FIG. 15B. A layered structure of the In—Sn—Zn—O-based crystal thus obtained can be expressed as a composition formula, In.sub.2SnZn.sub.2O.sub.7(ZnO).sub.m (m is 0 or a natural number).

(242) The above-described rule also applies to the following oxides: a four-component metal oxide, such as an In—Sn—Ga—Zn-based oxide; a three-component metal oxide, such as an In—Ga—Zn-based oxide (also referred to as IGZO), an In—Al—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Ga—Zn-based oxide, an Al—Ga—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Al—Zn-based oxide, an In—Hf—Zn-based oxide, an In—La—Zn-based oxide, an In—Ce—Zn-based oxide, an In—Pr—Zn-based oxide, an In—Nd—Zn-based oxide, an In—Sm—Zn-based oxide, an In—Eu—Zn-based oxide, an In—Gd—Zn-based oxide, an In—Tb—Zn-based oxide, an In—Dy—Zn-based oxide, an In—Ho—Zn-based oxide, an In—Er—Zn-based oxide, an In—Tm—Zn-based oxide, an In—Yb—Zn-based oxide, or an In—Lu—Zn-based oxide; a two-component metal oxide, such as an In—Zn-based oxide, a Sn—Zn-based oxide, an Al—Zn-based oxide, a Zn—Mg-based oxide, a Sn—Mg-based oxide, an In—Mg-based oxide, or an In—Ga-based oxide; and the like.

(243) As an example, FIG. 16A illustrates a model of a medium group included in a layered structure of an In—Ga—Zn—O-based system.

(244) In the medium group included in the layered structure of the In—Ga—Zn—O-based system in FIG. 16A, in the order starting from the top, In proximate to three tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half is bonded to Zn proximate to one tetracoordinate O in the upper half, the Zn is bonded to Ga proximate to one tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half through three tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the Zn, and the Ga is bonded to In proximate to three tetracoordinate O in each of the upper half and the lower half through one tetracoordinate O in the lower half with respect to the Ga. A plurality of such medium groups is bonded to constitute.

(245) FIG. 16B illustrates a large group consisting of three medium groups. FIG. 16C illustrates an

atomic arrangement in the layered structure in FIG. 16B when observed from the c-axis direction. (246) Here, electric charge of (hexacoordinate or pentacoordinate) In, electric charge of (tetra-coordinate) Zn, and electric charge of (pentacoordinate) Ga are +3, +2, +3, respectively, and thus electric charge of a small group including any of In, Zn, and Ga becomes 0. As a result, the total electric charge of a medium group consisting of a combination of such small groups is always 0.

(247) In order to form the layered structure of the In—Ga—Zn—O-based system, a large group may also be formed using a medium group in which the arrangement of In, Ga, and Zn is different from that in FIG. 16A.

(248) <Transistor Whose Channel is Formed in Oxide Semiconductor Layer>

(249) A transistor whose channel is formed in an oxide semiconductor layer is described with reference to FIGS. 17A to 17D. FIGS. 17A to 17D are schematic cross-sectional views each illustrating an example of the structure of the transistor.

(250) The transistor illustrated in FIG. 17A includes a conductive layer 601(a), an insulating layer 602(a), an oxide semiconductor layer 603(a), a conductive layer 605a(a), a conductive layer 605b(a), an insulating layer 606(a), and a conductive layer 608(a).

(251) The conductive layer 601(a) is provided over an element formation layer 600(a).

(252) The insulating layer 602(a) is provided over the conductive layer 601(a).

(253) The oxide semiconductor layer 603(a) overlaps with the conductive layer 601(a) with the insulating layer 602(a) provided therebetween.

(254) The conductive layer 605a(a) and the conductive layer 605b(a) are provided over the oxide semiconductor layer 603(a) and are electrically connected to the oxide semiconductor layer 603(a).

(255) The insulating layer 606(a) is provided over the oxide semiconductor layer 603(a), the conductive layer 605a(a), and the conductive layer 605a(b).

(256) The conductive layer 608(a) overlaps with the oxide semiconductor layer 603(a) with the insulating layer 606(a) provided therebetween.

(257) Both of the conductive layer 601(a) and the conductive layer 608(a) is not necessarily provided. When the conductive layer 608(a) is not provided, the insulating layer 606(a) is not necessarily provided.

(258) The transistor illustrated in FIG. 17B includes a conductive layer 601(b), an insulating layer 602(b), an oxide semiconductor layer 603(b), a conductive layer 605a(b), a conductive layer 605b(b), an insulating layer 606(b), and a conductive layer 608(b).

(259) The conductive layer 601(b) is provided over an element formation layer 600(b).

(260) The insulating layer 602(b) is provided over the conductive layer 601(b).

(261) The conductive layer 605a(b) and the conductive layer 605b(b) are each provided over part of the insulating layer 602(b).

(262) The oxide semiconductor layer 603(b) is provided over the conductive layer 605a(b) and the conductive layer 605b(b), and is electrically connected to the conductive layer 605a(b) and the conductive layer 605b(b). The oxide semiconductor layer 603(b) overlaps with the conductive layer 601(b) with the insulating layer 602(b) provided therebetween.

(263) The insulating layer 606(b) is provided over the oxide semiconductor layer 603(b), the conductive layer 605a(b), and the conductive layer 605b(b).

(264) The conductive layer 608(b) overlaps with the oxide semiconductor layer 603(b) with the insulating layer 606(b) provided therebetween.

(265) Both of the conductive layer 601(b) and the conductive layer 608(b) is not necessarily provided. When the conductive layer 608(b) is not provided, the insulating layer 606(b) is not necessarily provided.

(266) The transistor illustrated in FIG. 17C includes a conductive layer 601(c), an insulating layer 602(c), an oxide semiconductor layer 603(c), a conductive layer 605a(c), and a conductive layer 605b(c).

(267) The oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** includes a region **604a(c)** and a region **604b(c)**. The region **604a(c)** and the region **604b(c)** are provided apart from each other and dopants are added thereto. A region between the region **604a(c)** and the region **604b(c)** is a channel formation region. The oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** is provided over an element formation layer **600(c)**. The region **604a(c)** and the region **604b(c)** are not necessarily provided.

(268) The conductive layer **605a(c)** and the conductive layer **605b(c)** are provided over and electrically connected to the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)**. The sides of the conductive layer **605a(c)** and the conductive layer **605b(c)** are tapered.

(269) The conductive layer **605a(c)** overlaps with part of the region **604a(c)**; however, one embodiment of the present invention is not limited thereto. Overlap between the conductive layer **605a(c)** and part of the region **604a(c)** can lead to a reduction in the resistance between the conductive layer **605a(c)** and the region **604a(c)**. An entire region of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** which overlaps with the conductive layer **605a(c)** may form the region **604a(c)**.

(270) The conductive layer **605b(c)** overlaps with part of the region **604b(c)**; however, one embodiment of the present invention is not limited thereto. Overlap between the conductive layer **605b(c)** and part of the region **604b(c)** can lead to a reduction in the resistance between the conductive layer **605b(c)** and the region **604b(c)**. An entire region of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** which overlaps with the conductive layer **605b(c)** may form the region **604b(c)**.

(271) The insulating layer **602(c)** is provided over the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)**, the conductive layer **605a(c)**, and the conductive layer **605b(c)**.

(272) The conductive layer **601(c)** overlaps with the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** with the insulating layer **602(c)** provided therebetween. A region of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(c)** which overlaps with the conductive layer **601(c)** with the insulating layer **602(c)** provided therebetween is a channel formation region.

(273) The transistor illustrated in FIG. **17D** includes a conductive layer **601(d)**, an insulating layer **602(d)**, an oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)**, a conductive layer **605a(d)**, and a conductive layer **605b(d)**.

(274) The conductive layer **605a(d)** and the conductive layer **605b(d)** are provided over an element formation layer **600(d)**. The sides of the conductive layer **605a(d)** and the conductive layer **605b(d)** are tapered.

(275) The oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)** includes a region **604a(d)** and a region **604b(d)**. The region **604a(d)** and the region **604b(d)** are provided apart from each other and dopants are added thereto. A region between the region **604a(d)** and the region **604b(d)** is a channel formation region. For example, the oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)** is provided over the conductive layer **605a(d)**, the conductive layer **605b(d)**, and the element formation layer **600(d)**, and is electrically connected to the conductive layer **605a(d)** and the conductive layer **605b(d)**. The region **604a(d)** and the region **604b(d)** are not necessarily provided.

(276) The region **604a(d)** is electrically connected to the conductive layer **605a(d)**.

(277) The region **604b(d)** is electrically connected to the conductive layer **605b(d)**.

(278) The insulating layer **602(d)** is provided over the oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)**.

(279) The conductive layer **601(d)** overlaps with the oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)** with the insulating layer **602(d)** provided therebetween. A region of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(d)** which overlaps with the conductive layer **601(d)** with the insulating layer **602(d)** provided therebetween is a channel formation region.

(280) Next, each component illustrated in FIGS. **17A** to **17D** is described.

(281) An insulating layer, a substrate having an insulating surface, or the like can be used as the element formation layer **600(a)**, **600(b)**, **600(c)**, **600(d)**. Further, a layer over which an element is formed in advance can also be used as the element formation layer **600(a)**, **600(b)**, **600(c)**, **600(d)**.

(282) The conductive layer **601(a)**, **601(b)**, **601(c)**, **601(d)** functions as a gate of the transistor. A layer functioning as the gate of the transistor can be also referred to as a gate electrode or a gate

wiring.

(283) As the conductive layer **601(a)**, **601(b)**, **601(c)**, **601(d)**, it is possible to use, for example, a layer of a metal material such as molybdenum, magnesium, titanium, chromium, tantalum, tungsten, aluminum, copper, neodymium, or scandium or an alloy material containing any of these materials as a main component. The conductive layer **601(a)**, **601(b)**, **601(c)**, **601(d)** can also be formed by stacking layers of materials which can be applied to the conductive layer **601(a)**, **601(b)**, **601(c)**, **601(d)**.

(284) The insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** functions as a gate insulating layer of the transistor.

(285) As the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**, it is possible to use, for example, a silicon oxide layer, a silicon nitride layer, a silicon oxynitride layer, a silicon nitride oxide layer, an aluminum oxide layer, an aluminum nitride layer, an aluminum oxynitride layer, an aluminum nitride oxide layer, a hafnium oxide layer, or a lanthanum oxide layer. The insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** can also be formed by stacking layers of materials which can be applied to the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**.

(286) Alternatively, as the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**, an insulating layer of a material containing an element that belongs to Group 13 of the periodic table and oxygen can be used, for example. For example, in the case where the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** contain an element belonging to Group 13, an insulating layer containing an element belonging to Group 13 can be used as an insulating layer which is in contact with the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)**, whereby an interface state between the insulating layer and the oxide semiconductor layer can be improved.

(287) Examples of the material containing an element that belongs to Group 13 and oxygen include gallium oxide, aluminum oxide, aluminum gallium oxide, and gallium aluminum oxide. Aluminum gallium oxide refers to a substance in which the amount of aluminum is larger than that of gallium in atomic percent, and gallium aluminum oxide refers to a substance in which the amount of gallium is larger than or equal to that of aluminum in atomic percent. For example, a material represented by Al.sub.2O.sub.x ($x=3+\alpha$, where α is larger than 0 and smaller than 1),

Ga.sub.2O.sub.x ($x=3+\alpha$, where α is larger than 0 and smaller than 1), or

$\text{Ga.sub.xAl.sub.2-xO.sub.3+\alpha}$ (x is larger than 0 and smaller than 2 and α is larger than 0 and smaller than 1) can be used.

(288) The insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** can also be formed by stacking layers of materials which can be applied to the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**. For example, the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** can be formed of stacked layers containing gallium oxide represented by Ga.sub.2O.sub.x . Further, the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** may be formed of a stack of an insulating layer containing gallium oxide represented by Ga.sub.2O.sub.x and an insulating layer containing aluminum oxide represented by Al.sub.2O.sub.x .

(289) Further, when the channel length of the transistor is 30 nm, the thickness of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** may be about 5 nm. In that case, a short-channel effect of the transistor can be suppressed by using a CAAC oxide semiconductor layer as the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)**.

(290) Dopants imparting n-type or p-type conductivity are added to the region **604a(c)**, **604b(c)**, **604a(d)**, **604b(d)**, and the region functions as a source or a drain of the transistor. As the dopants, for example, one or more of elements of Group 13 in the periodic table (e.g., boron), elements of Group 15 in the periodic table (e.g., nitrogen, phosphorus, and arsenic), and rare gas elements (e.g., helium, argon, and xenon) can be used. A region functioning as a source of the transistor is also referred to as a source region, and a region functioning as a drain of the transistor is also referred to as a drain region. Since addition of the dopants to the region **604a(c)**, **604b(c)**, **604a(d)**, **604b(d)** leads to a reduction in the contact resistance with the conductive layer, the transistor can be

downsized.

(291) The conductive layers **605a(a)** to **605a(d)** function of a source and a drain of the transistor, and the conductive layers **605b(a)** and **605b(d)** function as a source and a drain of the transistor. A layer functioning as a source of the transistor is also referred to as a source electrode or a source wiring, and a layer functioning as a drain of the transistor is also referred to as a drain electrode or a drain wiring.

(292) As the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)**, for example, a layer of a metal material such as aluminum, magnesium, chromium, copper, tantalum, titanium, molybdenum, or tungsten, or an alloy material which contains any of the above metal materials as a main component can be used. For example, the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)** can be formed using a layer of an alloy material containing copper, magnesium, and aluminum. The conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)** can also be formed by stacking layers of materials which can be applied to the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)**. For example, the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)** can be formed by stacking a layer of an alloy material containing copper, magnesium, and aluminum and a layer containing copper.

(293) As the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)**, a layer containing conductive metal oxide can also be used. Examples of the conductive metal oxide are indium oxide, tin oxide, zinc oxide, an oxide of indium and tin, and an oxide of indium and zinc. The conductive metal oxide applicable to the conductive layer **605a(a)**, **605a(b)**, **605a(c)**, **605a(d)**, **605b(a)**, **605b(b)**, **605b(c)**, **605b(d)** may contain silicon oxide.

(294) As the insulating layer **606(a)**, **606(b)**, a layer of a material that can be used for the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** can be used. The insulating layer **606(a)**, **606(b)** can be formed of stacked layers of materials that can be used for the insulating layer **606(a)**, **606(b)**. For example, the insulating layer **606(a)**, **606(b)** may be formed of a silicon oxide layer, an aluminum oxide layer, or the like. For example, with application of an aluminum oxide layer to the insulating layer **606(a)**, **606(b)**, impurities (water) can be more prevented from entering the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)** and effectively prevent oxygen can be more prevented from being eliminated from the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**.

(295) The conductive layer **608(a)**, **608(b)** functions as a gate of the transistor. When the transistor includes both of the conductive layers **601(a)** and **608(a)** or both of the conductive layers **601(b)** and **608(b)**, one of the conductive layers **601(a)** and **608(a)** or one of the conductive layers **601(b)** and **608(b)** is also referred to as a back gate, a back gate electrode, or a back gate wiring. In this manner, a plurality of conductive layers each functioning as a gate may be provided with the channel formation layer provided therebetween, whereby the threshold voltage of the transistor can be more easily controlled.

(296) As the conductive layer **608(a)**, **608(b)**, a layer of a material that can be used for the conductive layer **601(a)**, **601(b)**, **601(c)**, **601(d)** can be used, for example. The conductive layer **608(a)**, **608(b)** may also be formed of stacked layers of materials that can be used for the conductive layer **608(a)**, **608(b)**.

(297) Further, an insulating layer functioning as a channel protective layer may be formed of stacked layers of materials that can be used for the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**.

(298) Further, a base layer may be formed over the element formation layer **600(a)**, **600(b)**, **600(c)**, **600(d)**, and the transistor may be formed over the base layer. In that case, a layer of a material that can be used for the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)** can be used as the base layer, for example. The base layer may also be formed of stacked layers of materials that can be used for the insulating layer **602(a)**, **602(b)**, **602(c)**, **602(d)**. For example, a base layer may be formed of a stack of an aluminum oxide layer and a silicon oxide layer, and thereby elimination of oxygen in the base layer through the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** can be suppressed.

(299) Further, the insulating layer in contact with the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** may be formed to contain excess oxygen, whereby oxygen can be more easily supplied to the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)**. Accordingly, oxygen defects in the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** and in an interface between the insulating layer and the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** can be reduced; thus, the carrier density of the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** can be more reduced. One embodiment of the present invention is not limited thereto. The oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** may be formed to contain excess oxygen in the manufacturing process, also in which case elimination of oxygen from the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)** can be suppressed by the above-described insulating layer in contact with the oxide semiconductor layer **603(a)**, **603(b)**, **603(c)**, **603(d)**.

(300) <Characteristics of Transistor Whose Channel is Formed in Oxide Semiconductor Layer>

(301) In a transistor in which an oxide semiconductor containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components is used for a channel formation region, favorable characteristics can be provided by depositing the oxide semiconductor while heating a substrate or by performing heat treatment after an oxide semiconductor layer is formed. The “main component” means that the element is contained in composition at 5 atomic % or more.

(302) By intentionally heating the substrate after formation of the oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components, the field-effect mobility of the transistor can be improved. In addition, the threshold voltage of the transistor can be shifted in the positive direction to make the transistor normally off.

(303) For example, FIGS. **18A** to **18C** each show characteristics of a transistor that includes an oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components and having a channel length L of 3 μm and a channel width W of 10 μm , and a gate insulating layer with a thickness of 100 nm. Here, $V_{\text{sub.d}}$ was set at 10 V.

(304) FIG. **18A** shows characteristics of a transistor whose oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components was formed by a sputtering method without heating a substrate intentionally. The field-effect mobility of the transistor was 18.8 cm^2/Vsec . On the other hand, when the oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components is formed while heating the substrate intentionally, the field-effect mobility can be improved. FIG. **18B** shows characteristics of a transistor whose oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components was formed while heating a substrate at 200° C. The field-effect mobility of the transistor was 32.2 cm^2/Vsec .

(305) The field-effect mobility can be further enhanced by performing heat treatment after formation of the oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components. FIG. **18C** shows characteristics of a transistor whose oxide semiconductor layer containing In, Sn, and Zn as its main components was formed by sputtering at 200° C. and then subjected to heat treatment at 650° C. The field-effect mobility of the transistor was 34.5 cm^2/Vsec .

(306) Such substrate heating or heat treatment acts such that hydrogen and a hydroxyl group, which are adverse impurities for an oxide semiconductor, are not included in the film or are removed from the film. That is, an oxide semiconductor can be highly purified by removing hydrogen serving as a donor impurity from the oxide semiconductor, which enables a transistor to be a normally-off transistor and enables the off-state current of the transistor to be reduced to 1 $\text{aA}/\mu\text{m}$ or lower. Here, the off-state current is described per micrometer of channel width.

(307) FIG. **19** shows a relation between the off-state current of a transistor and the inverse of substrate temperature (absolute temperature) at measurement. Here, for simplicity, a value ($1000/T$) obtained by multiplying the inverse of substrate temperature at measurement by 1000 is indicated in the horizontal axis.

(308) As shown in FIG. **19**, the off-state current was 0.1 $\text{aA}/\mu\text{m}$ ($1 \times 10^{-19} \text{ A}/\mu\text{m}$) or smaller and 10 $\text{zA}/\mu\text{m}$ ($1 \times 10^{-20} \text{ A}/\mu\text{m}$) or smaller when the substrate temperature was 125° C. and

85° C., respectively. The proportional relation between the logarithm of the off-state current and the inverse of the temperature suggests that the off-state current at room temperature (27° C.) is 0.1 zA/ μm ($1 \times 10^{\text{sup.}-22}$ A/ μm) or smaller. As is apparent from the above, the off-state current can be 1 aA/ μm ($1 \times 10^{\text{sup.}-18}$ A/ μm) or smaller, 100 zA/ μm ($1 \times 10^{\text{sup.}-19}$ A/ μm) or smaller, and 1 zA/ μm ($1 \times 10^{\text{sup.}-21}$ A/ μm) or smaller at 125° C., 85° C., and room temperature, respectively.

(309) The transistor described in this embodiment can be used for the semiconductor device described in Embodiment 1 or 2, whereby the semiconductor device can operate stably. In particular, by using the transistor described in this embodiment as the transistor **102**, the off-state current of the transistor **102** can be reduced; accordingly, the amount of charge leaks from the capacitor **101** can be reduced, and thus the frequency of times of holding the offset voltage in the capacitor **101** can be reduced.

(310) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any other embodiment and the like.

Embodiment 6

(311) In this embodiment, examples of an electronic device equipped with the semiconductor device, the shift register, the display device, or the like described in any of the above embodiments are described.

(312) FIG. **20A** shows a portable game console that includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, a speaker **9633**, operation keys **9635**, a connection terminal **9636**, a recording medium reading portion **9672**, and the like. The portable game console illustrated in FIG. **20A** can have a function of reading a program or data stored in a recording medium to display on the display portion; a function of sharing data by wireless communication with another portable game console; or the like. The function of the portable game console illustrated in FIG. **20A** is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(313) FIG. **20B** illustrates a digital camera which includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, speakers **9633**, operation keys **9635**, a connection terminal **9636**, a shutter button **9676**, an image receiving portion **9677**, and the like. The digital camera in FIG. **20B** can have a function of taking a still image and/or a moving image, a function of automatically or manually correcting the taken image, a function of detecting various kinds of data from an antenna, a function of holding the taken image or the data detected from the antenna, a function of displaying the taken image or the data detected from the antenna on the display portion, and the like. The function of the digital camera illustrated in FIG. **20B** is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(314) FIG. **20C** illustrates a television set which includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, speakers **9633**, operation keys **9635**, a connection terminal **9636**, and the like. The television set in FIG. **20C** has a function of converting an electric wave for television into an image signal, a function of converting an image signal into a signal suitable for display, a function of converting the frame frequency of an image signal, and the like. The function of the television set illustrated in FIG. **20C** is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(315) FIG. **20D** illustrates a monitor for electronic computers (personal computer) (the monitor is also referred to as a PC monitor) that includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, and the like. As an example, in the monitor in FIG. **20D**, a window-type display portion **9653** is provided for the display portion **9631**. Note that FIG. **20D** illustrates the window-type display portion **9653** in the display portion **9631** for explanation; another symbol such as an icon or an image may be displayed. In the monitor for a personal computer, an image signal is rewritten only at the time of data inputting in many cases, which is preferable to apply the method for driving a display device in the above-described embodiment. The function of the monitor illustrated in FIG. **20D** is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(316) FIG. **21A** illustrates a computer that includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, a speaker **9633**, operation keys **9635**, a connection terminal **9636**, a pointing device **9681**, an external connection port **9680**, and the like. The computer illustrated in FIG. **21A** can have a function of

displaying various kinds of data (e.g., a still image, a moving image, and a text image) on the display portion; a function of controlling processing by various kinds of software (programs); a communication function such as wireless communication or wire communication; a function of connecting with various computer networks by using communication function; a function of transmitting or receiving various kinds of data by using communication function; or the like. The function of the computer illustrated in FIG. 21A is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(317) FIG. 21B illustrates a mobile phone that includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, a speaker **9633**, operation keys **9635**, a microphone **9638**, and the like. The mobile phone illustrated in FIG. 21B can have a function of displaying a variety of data (e.g., a still image, a moving image, and a text image) on the display portion; a function of displaying a calendar, date, the time, and the like on the display portion; a function of operating or editing data displayed on the display portion; a function of controlling processing by various kinds of software (programs); or the like. The function of the mobile phone illustrated in FIG. 21B is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided.

(318) FIG. 21C illustrates electronic paper (also referred to as an e-book or an e-book reader) that includes a housing **9630**, a display portion **9631**, operation keys **9632**, and the like. The electronic paper illustrated in FIG. 21C has a function of displaying various kinds of data (e.g., a still image, a moving image, and a text image) on the display portion, a function of displaying a calendar, a date, the time, or the like on the display portion, a function of operating or editing data displayed on the display portion, a function of controlling processing by various kinds of software (programs), or the like. The function of the electronic paper illustrated in FIG. 21C is not limited thereto, and various functions can be provided. FIG. 21D illustrates another electronic paper. The electronic paper in FIG. 21D has a structure in which a solar battery **9651** and a battery **9652** are added to the electronic paper in FIG. 21C. When a reflective display device is used as the display portion **9631**, the electronic paper is expected to be used in a comparatively bright environment, in which case the structure in FIG. 21D is preferable because the solar battery **9651** can efficiently generate power and the battery **9652** can efficiently charge power. Note that it is advantageous to use a lithium ion battery as the battery **9652** in a reduction in size or the like.

(319) The semiconductor device described in Embodiment 1, the semiconductor device described in Embodiment 2, the shift register described in Embodiment 3, or the display device described in Embodiment 4 can be applied to any electronic device described in this embodiment, whereby the electronic device can operate even when a transistor thereof is a depletion transistor.

(320) This embodiment can be implemented in appropriate combination with any structure described in any other embodiment.

(321) This application is based on Japanese Patent Application serial no. 2011-108133 filed with Japan Patent Office on May 13, 2011, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

Claims

1. A semiconductor device comprising: a shift register configured to output a plurality of output signals, wherein the shift register comprises a first transistor, a second transistor, a third transistor, a fourth transistor, a fifth transistor, a sixth transistor, a first capacitor, and a second capacitor, wherein one of a source and a drain of the first transistor is electrically connected to a first wiring, wherein one of a source and a drain of the second transistor is electrically connected to the first wiring, wherein one of a source and a drain of the third transistor is electrically connected to a gate of the first transistor, wherein the other of the source and a drain of the third transistor is electrically connected to a second wiring, wherein a first electrode of the first capacitor is electrically connected to the second wiring, wherein a second electrode of the first capacitor is

electrically connected to one of a source and a drain of the fourth transistor, wherein the other of the source and the drain of the fourth transistor is electrically connected to a third wiring, wherein one of a source and a drain of the fifth transistor is electrically connected to a gate of the second transistor, wherein the other of the source and the drain of the fifth transistor is electrically connected to the third wiring, wherein a first electrode of the second capacitor is electrically connected to the gate of the second transistor, wherein a second electrode of the second capacitor is not electrically connected to a gate of the fifth transistor, wherein one of a source and a drain of the sixth transistor is electrically connected to the gate of the first transistor, and wherein a gate of the sixth transistor is electrically connected to the gate of the second transistor.

2. The semiconductor device according to claim 1, wherein one output signal of the plurality of output signals is output from the first wiring, wherein an input signal is input to the second wiring, and wherein a potential is supplied to the third wiring.

3. The semiconductor device according to claim 1, wherein a ratio of a channel width to a channel length of the sixth transistor is larger than a ratio of a channel width to a channel length of the third transistor.

4. The semiconductor device according to claim 1, wherein the first transistor, the second transistor, the third transistor, the fourth transistor, the fifth transistor, and the sixth transistor have the same type of conductivity.

5. The semiconductor device according to claim 1, wherein the shift register comprises a first flip-flop circuit and a second flip-flop circuit, wherein the first flip-flop circuit comprises the first transistor, the second transistor, the third transistor, the fourth transistor, the fifth transistor, the sixth transistor, the first capacitor, and the second capacitor, and wherein an output terminal of the first flip-flop circuit is electrically connected to an input terminal of the second flip-flop circuit via the first wiring.

6. The semiconductor device according to claim 1, wherein a second electrode of the second capacitor is electrically connected to a fourth wiring.
